SHIP: Structured and Hierarchical Insight with Privacy

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Abstract

Extracting insights from textual data while protecting user privacy is increasingly important. Existing methods produce private insights in diverse forms for different analytical purposes, making their utility difficult to assess and compare. In this work, we formulate differentially private (DP) insights as reusable representations for answering analytical queries, providing a common basis for utility assessment. Answering these queries, however, requires fine-grained details and cross-attribute statistics that existing representations may omit. To capture this information, we introduce Structured and Hierarchical Insight with Privacy (SHIP), which automatically maps queries to attributes, builds a hierarchical hybrid taxonomy, and releases a DP synthetic table for further analysis. We also develop an evaluation protocol based primarily on QA performance and structured fidelity. Our experiments demonstrate SHIP's strong performance on both measures relative to existing private insight baselines, while identifying queries that remain challenging for structured representations.

1 Introduction

Modern organizations collect vast amounts of textual data from their users. In particular, the rapid development of generative AI has introduced new user-facing tools, such as chatbots and AI agents, that continuously generate large volumes of data. Analyzing these data is crucial for organizations to understand user needs, improve their products and models, and guide decision-making. However, these data often contain personal information, making privacy protection essential for such analysis.

Various insight extraction systems have been developed to analyze such textual data. For example, Anthropic proposes Clio (Tamkin et al., 2024), which transforms large collections of AI-assistant conversations into extracted facets, hierarchical semantic clusters, and cluster-level summaries. Google's Urania (Liu et al., 2025) extends this paradigm with formal end-to-end DP guarantees, offering stronger privacy protection against adversarial attacks (Annamalai et al., 2026). Moreover, OpenAI (Chatterji et al., 2025) and Google (Cheu et al., 2025) have explored structured approaches to extracting insights. Google's approach additionally provides formal DP guarantees through DP aggregation, with LLM-based structured summarization in trusted execution environments. Several other works further investigate applications of insights across various domains such as healthcare, science, and generative AI usage analysis (Codreanu et al., 2026; McCain et al., 2025; Anthropic, 2026; Costa-Gomes et al., 2026).

These systems produce insights in different forms, reflecting different analytical purposes. Clio and Urania support exploratory analysis with limited prior specification, while structured approaches organize information along targeted attributes. Existing evaluations are often tailored to individual methods' purposes and output formats, leaving no common basis for comparing analytical utility across methods (Tamkin et al., 2024; Liu et al., 2025). We therefore need a shared description of information needs that accommodates diverse analytical purposes and provides concrete objectives for DP insight design and evaluation.

In this work, we focus on a setting in which analysts have a *workload* of dataset-level analytical queries to guide insight extraction. The workload makes information needs explicit and provides a concrete criterion for utility. For example[1], access to a medical dataset could inspire the question "What are the users' primary symptoms and chief complaints, and for those symptoms, what diag-

[*]This work was primarily done during an internship at Google.

[1]Refer to Table 4 and Table 5 for more examples.

nostic tests do the doctors suggest?" Answering such queries requires both *insight depth* (resolving fine-grained categories within each attribute, such as specific symptoms and tests) and *insight breadth* (preserving cross-attribute joint distributions, such as which tests are suggested for which symptoms). In this setting, cluster-level summaries and keyword statistics are often too coarse for detailed attribute statistics and do not directly expose cross-attribute joint distributions. Flat structured baselines map records directly to explicit categorical attributes, but rely on flat, single-level taxonomies that either miss fine-grained subcategories or require static schemas. These limitations motivate a workload-driven DP framework that simultaneously captures insight depth and insight breadth.

To address these challenges, we formalize the DP insight extraction, develop a workload-driven extraction method, and propose a shared evaluation protocol. Our main contributions are as follows:

- **Workload-based Formulation and Evaluation.** We formulate DP insight extraction from a query-answering perspective, viewing an insight as a reusable representation of a textual corpus that supports a workload of analytical queries. To evaluate analytical utility independently of the output format, we use a shared offline agent to answer the same queries solely from each method's released insights, and introduce a complementary metric to evaluate semantic and distributional fidelity for structured insights.
- **The SHIP Framework.** We introduce SHIP, an end-to-end framework for extracting structured insights under rigorous DP guarantees. It automatically maps the workload to attributes, builds a hierarchical and hybrid taxonomy that combines private open-set discovery with adaptive supplementation by a taxonomy model (Davidson et al., 2026) to retain fine-grained details (depth), and applies DP tabular synthesis (McKenna et al., 2024) to release a reusable private table that preserves cross-attribute correlations (breadth).
- **Empirical Analysis of Utility and Limitations.** With its workload-aware tabular structure and hierarchical taxonomy, SHIP achieves average gains of 12.7% points in deterministic QA accuracy and 9.0 points in open-ended QA F_1 on WildChat, compared with the strongest baseline across privacy budgets. We also identify query structures, such as long topic-switching sequences, that remain challenging for SHIP's current representation.

2 Preliminaries

2.1 Differential Privacy

To provide formal privacy guarantees over sensitive user interaction data, we ground our framework in Differential Privacy (DP). Two datasets $\mathcal{D}, \mathcal{D}'$ are defined as *neighboring* (denoted $\mathcal{D} \sim \mathcal{D}'$) if they differ by at most one individual record.

Definition 1 (Differential Privacy (Dwork et al., 2006))**.** *A randomized mechanism $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies (ε, δ)-differential privacy if, for all neighboring datasets $\mathcal{D} \sim \mathcal{D}'$ and every measurable subset of possible outputs $\mathcal{S} \subseteq Range(\mathcal{M})$:*

$$\mathbb{P}[\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{D}) \in \mathcal{S}] \leq e^{\varepsilon}\, \mathbb{P}[\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{D}') \in \mathcal{S}] + \delta. \quad (1)$$

To simplify privacy accounting across iterative operations, we track the privacy loss using zero-Concentrated Differential Privacy (zCDP).

Definition 2 ((δ, ρ)-zCDP (Bun and Steinke, 2016))**.** *A randomized mechanism $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies δ-approximate ρ-zCDP if, for every pair of neighboring datasets $\mathcal{D} \sim \mathcal{D}'$, there exist events E and E' with probabilities at least $1 - \delta$ such that, letting P and Q denote the output distributions of $\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{D})$ and $\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{D}')$ conditioned on E and E', respectively, for every $\alpha > 1$,*

$$\max\{D_\alpha(P\|Q), D_\alpha(Q\|P)\} \leq \rho\alpha, \quad (2)$$

where $D_\alpha(P\|Q)$ denotes the Rényi divergence of order α. When $\delta = 0$, this reduces to ρ-zCDP.

2.2 Terminology

In this section, we introduce the terminology used throughout the paper. Let $\mathcal{D} = \{x_1, \ldots, x_N\}$ denote a corpus of N textual records, such as user prompts or multi-turn dialogues. We begin by describing analysts' information needs through queries and workloads, and then define insights as reusable resources that support these needs.

Definition 3 (Query and Workload)**.** *A **query** q is a natural-language specification of a dataset-level analytical information need, asking about properties, patterns, or relationships in a dataset $\mathcal{D}$. A **workload** $\mathcal{W} = \{q_1, \ldots, q_k\}$ is a collection of queries representing the analytical needs.*

Throughout this work, we focus on dataset-level analytical queries rather than retrieving information from individual records, as the latter are inherently less compatible with privacy.

Definition 4 (Workload-Aware Insight)**.** *Given a dataset $\mathcal{D}$ and a workload $\mathcal{W}$, an **insight** $\mathcal{S}$ is a data structure derived from $\mathcal{D}$ that can provide answers to the queries in $\mathcal{W}$.*

In this work, we primarily study *structured insights*, which organize information in a tabular form. We therefore introduce the basic components of this representation.

Definition 5 (Attribute & Taxonomy)**.** *An **attribute** A_i is an observable semantic dimension, and a **taxonomy** $\mathcal{T} = \{A_1 : \Omega_1, \ldots, A_m : \Omega_m\}$ associates each attribute A_i with its value domain Ω_i.*

2.3 Problem Statement

With the necessary definitions provided in the previous sections, we define the workload-driven DP insight extraction problem as follows.

Definition 6 (Workload-Driven DP Insight Extraction)**.** *Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a private textual dataset and $\mathcal{W}$ a workload of analytical queries.*[2] *The task of workload-driven DP insight extraction is to design a mechanism $\mathcal{F}$ that releases an insight representation $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{D}, \mathcal{W})$ under (ε, δ)-DP, such that $\mathcal{S}$ serves as an interpretable and reusable resource from which queries in $\mathcal{W}$ can be answered without further access to $\mathcal{D}$.*

3 Related Work

Existing approaches to private insight follow a common two-stage structure: a language model inference step that extracts annotations or summaries from each record, followed by an aggregation and privatization step (via clustering, aggregation, and/or differential privacy) that produces a dataset-level release. Within this shared framework, existing techniques can be organized along five capabilities (Table 1): whether they satisfy formal differential privacy, capture *insight depth* (multi-level hierarchical granularity within a semantic dimension), capture *insight breadth* (joint distributions across multiple semantic dimensions), discover categories from data (open-set), and adapt to an explicit query workload.

Clustering-based approaches include Clio (Tamkin et al., 2024) and its DP counterpart Urania (Liu et al., 2025). Clio extracts multiple facets, including specific attributes and textual summaries, clusters data, and produces cluster-level summaries. It applies heuristic privacy safeguards without formal DP guarantees, leaving it vulnerable to demonstrated reconstruction attacks (Annamalai et al., 2026). Urania similarly generates cluster-level insights but uses DP k-means for clustering and privately selected keywords for summary generation, providing a formal DP guarantee. Although useful for exploratory analysis, the cluster-centric outputs do not provide an explicit, reusable joint distribution over attributes for workload-driven queries.

Table 1: Taxonomy of insight extraction paradigms across five core capabilities: Clio (Tamkin et al., 2024), Urania (Liu et al., 2025), Chatterji et al. (2025), `Flat-Open` (Cheu et al., 2025), `Flat-Close` (Hu et al., 2025), and SHIP.

Method	DP	Depth	Breadth	Open-Set	Workload
Clio	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗
Urania	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗
Chatterji et al.	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
`Flat-Open`	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗
`Flat-Close`	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗
SHIP (Ours)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Taxonomy-based approaches map each record directly to discrete categories along explicit semantic attributes (Chatterji et al., 2025; Cheu et al., 2025; Hu et al., 2025). Given a collection of m attributes, structured approaches use a language model to classify each record $x_i \in \mathcal{D}$ into a tuple of categories $(y_i^{(1)}, \ldots, y_i^{(m)}) \in \Omega_1 \times \cdots \times \Omega_m$, reducing the unstructured corpus to a simple table. However, existing mechanisms have limitations in insight depth and insight breadth. On the one hand, open-set structured summarization (`Flat-Open`; Cheu et al., 2025) discovers categories through DP partition selection (Desfontaines et al., 2021), which can miss low-frequency categories. The single-attribute formulation considered in their work does not explicitly address multi-attribute analysis. Extending it through independent 1-way histograms would divide the privacy budget across attributes, raising selection thresholds and further reducing category coverage. These independent releases would still not preserve cross-attribute joint distributions.

On the other hand, closed-set structured synthesis (`Flat-Close`; Chatterji et al., 2025; Hu et al., 2025) specifies each candidate domain Ω_j a pri-

[2] In practice, users can construct the workload by prompting an LLM or by specifying their own queries of interest.

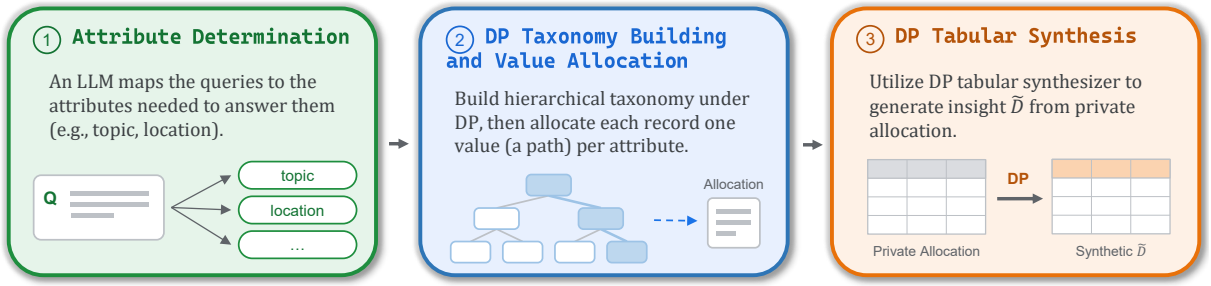


Figure 1: Overview of SHIP's workflow. Given a query workload, SHIP identifies relevant attributes and constructs a hierarchical taxonomy. Each private text record is then mapped to attribute values, forming a tabular representation. Finally, a DP tabular synthesizer processes this representation to release the final insight $\tilde{D}$.

ori using domain experts or a zero-shot language model without accessing the private dataset $\mathcal{D}$. After classifying each record into the pre-specified taxonomy, the differentially private variant (Hu et al., 2025) applies a marginal-based synthetic data mechanism such as AIM (McKenna et al., 2024), which privately measures low-order marginals and synthesizes a tabular dataset $\tilde{\mathcal{D}}$. While this approach captures insight breadth, its utility depends on the quality of the taxonomy. Finally, none of these existing paradigms formalize the downstream analytical queries that the insight is intended to support, leaving attribute selection manual and cross-format evaluation ad hoc.

4 Method

In this section, we introduce our method, Structured Hierarchical Insights with Privacy (SHIP), which works in three steps: it identifies the information dimensions required by the workload, constructs a hierarchical structured representation over these dimensions, and privately synthesizes their joint distribution, as shown in Figure 1.

4.1 DP Taxonomy Building

As discussed in Section 3, open-set discovery may miss low-frequency categories that fall below the DP threshold, whereas closed-set taxonomies rely on static priors that may be inaccurate (see Section 5.1 and Appendix C.4). To capture fine-grained *insight depth* while maintaining coverage, we introduce a hierarchical hybrid category proposal mechanism (Algorithm 1, Figure 2; full pseudocode in Algorithm 3) that combines open-set discovery with closed-set supplementation across multiple levels of granularity (Bagdasaryan et al., 2022; Zhu et al., 2020; Tamkin et al., 2024).

Taxonomy construction proceeds top-down for

Algorithm 1: Hierarchical Hybrid DP Taxonomy Building

Input: Records $\mathcal{D} = \{x_1, \ldots, x_N\}$, Dataset description S_D, Max depth d, Attribute A, Privacy parameters $(\rho_{\text{step}}, \delta_{\text{step}})$, Taxonomy model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{tax}}$, Classification model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}$.

Output: Taxonomy $\mathcal{T}_A$, Internal record paths $\{y_i\}_{i=1}^N$.

$\rho_{\text{open}} = 0.9\rho_{\text{step}}, \quad \rho_{\text{close}} = 0.1\rho_{\text{step}}$;

$\sigma_{\text{open}} = 1/\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{open}}}, \quad \sigma_{\text{close}} = 1/\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{close}}}$;

Compute τ_{open} and τ_{close};

Initialize tree-like domain Ω_A with root $\perp$;

for $l \leftarrow 1$ **to** d, *each level* $l-1$ *category* c_p *in* Ω_A **do**

  $\mathcal{D}_p \leftarrow$ records assigned to c_p;

  Classify $\mathcal{D}$ via $\mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}$ to obtain domain $\mathcal{C}_{\text{open}}$ and allocation results $\{y_i\}$ and conduct partition selection;

  Obtain supplementary domain $\mathcal{C}_{\text{comp}}$ through $\mathcal{M}_{\text{tax}}$ and re-allocation results $\{y_i\}$ through $\mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}$;

  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}} = \mathcal{C}_{\text{open}} \cup \mathcal{C}_{\text{comp}}$

  Add $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}}$ as children of c_p in Ω_A and allocate $\mathcal{D}_p$ using $\{y_i\}$;

return $\{A : \Omega_A\}, \{y_i\}_{i=1}^N$;

up to d levels. At each parent category c_p, we first use the classification model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}$ to freely propose subcategories from its assigned records, which we call "*Discovery*". To ensure differential privacy, these proposals are filtered using the Gaussian Thresholding Mechanism (Desfontaines et al., 2021) with threshold $\tau_{\text{open}}(\sigma, \delta) = 1 + \sigma\Phi^{-1}(1 - \delta)$, where σ is the noise level and Φ is the standard Gaussian cumulative distribution function. Data-driven discovery can nonetheless miss concepts

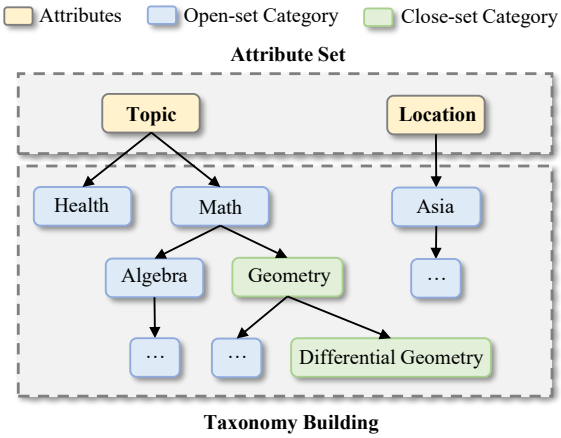


Figure 2: An illustration of SHIP's taxonomy building step. The hierarchical taxonomy originates from the top-level attribute set, integrating with open-set categories (blue) with complementary close-set categories (green) for multi-level categorization.

whose counts fall below the privacy threshold, particularly when the budget is divided across multiple attributes and hierarchical levels. Conditioned on the surviving categories $\mathcal{C}_{\text{open}}$, we therefore prompt the taxonomy model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{tax}}$ to propose mutually exclusive complementary categories $\mathcal{C}_{\text{comp}}$ using its world knowledge about the attribute, dataset description, and parent category c_p, which we call "*Complementary Proposal*". Records whose initial categories did not survive are reclassified over the combined candidates. The surviving categories $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}}$ are attached to c_p, and records are allocated for refinement at the next level, while `other` and `none` remain terminal. The resulting root-to-leaf paths define the hierarchical domain Ω_A and the corresponding record path assignments.

4.2 SHIP

Based on the taxonomy discovery mechanism introduced above, we introduce SHIP (Algorithm 2 and Figure 1), consisting of three main components:

Workload Analysis. For a workload $\mathcal{W}$, SHIP first analyzes it through a highly capable model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{attr}}$ and finds atomic features needed to answer queries in it. This step returns an attribute set $\mathcal{A}$ for further structured insight extraction.

Taxonomy Building and Category Allocation. Given a set of target attributes $\mathcal{A}$ and a maximum depth d, SHIP builds the hierarchical taxonomy $\mathcal{T}$ by repeatedly applying Algorithm 1 for all attributes $A \in \mathcal{A}$. The privacy budget is uniformly

Algorithm 2: SHIP

Input: Records $\mathcal{D} = \{x_1, \ldots, x_N\}$, Depth d, Workload $\mathcal{W}$, Dataset description S_D, Privacy budget $(\rho_{\text{aim}}, \rho_{\text{tax}}, \delta_{\text{tax}})$, Attribute model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{attr}}$, Taxonomy model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{tax}}$, Classification model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}$.

Output: Taxonomy $\mathcal{T}$, Insight $\widetilde{\mathcal{D}}$.

Obtain attribute set $\mathcal{A} \leftarrow \mathcal{M}_{\text{attr}}(\mathcal{W})$;
Obtain ρ_{step} and δ_{step} via Equation (3);
for $A \in \mathcal{A}$ **do**
  $\mathcal{T}_A, \{y_i^{(A)}\}_{i=1}^N \leftarrow$ Algorithm 1;
$\mathcal{T} \leftarrow \bigcup_{A \in \mathcal{A}} \mathcal{T}_A$;
$\widetilde{\mathcal{D}} \leftarrow \text{AIM}(\{(y_i^{(A)})_{A \in \mathcal{A}}\}_{i=1}^N, \mathcal{T}, \rho_{\text{aim}})$;
return $\mathcal{T}, \widetilde{\mathcal{D}}$;

allocated across all attributes and hierarchy levels:

$$\rho_{\text{step}} = \frac{\rho_{\text{tax}}}{|\mathcal{A}| \cdot d}, \qquad \delta_{\text{step}} = \frac{\delta_{\text{tax}}}{|\mathcal{A}| \cdot d}. \tag{3}$$

For each attribute $A \in \mathcal{A}$, Algorithm 1 returns the attribute taxonomy $\mathcal{T}_A = \{A : \Omega_A\}$ and root-to-leaf record assignments $\{y_i^{(A)}\}_{i=1}^N$ for each attribute A. We merge them and obtain a multi-attribute taxonomy $\mathcal{T}$ and a multi-dimensional allocation table $\tilde{D}$.

Private Tabular Synthesis and Release. After taxonomy construction, we can release the DP taxonomy and separately privatized per-attribute histograms. However, the record-level category assignments $\{(y_i^{(A)})_{A \in \mathcal{A}}\}_{i=1}^N$ that capture cross-attribute correlations remain private. We then use the taxonomy $\mathcal{T}$ to define discrete attribute domains and apply a DP synthetic data mechanism, AIM (McKenna et al., 2024), with the privacy budget ρ_{aim}. AIM privately measures low-order marginals over the category assignments and estimates a dataset $\widetilde{\mathcal{D}}$ that preserves those marginals well. The resulting structured insights, consisting of the taxonomy $\mathcal{T}$ and the synthetic dataset $\widetilde{\mathcal{D}}$, can be released to answer queries and conduct downstream analyses. Since these operations rely solely on the released DP outputs, the post-processing property of DP ensures that they do not incur any additional privacy cost.

4.3 Privacy Guarantee

In this section, we formally evaluate the privacy guarantee of SHIP through Theorem 1. The detailed proof is provided in Appendix E.

Theorem 1 (Privacy Guarantee of SHIP). *Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a private dataset under unbounded DP. We define $\rho = \rho_{tax} + \rho_{aim}$ and $\bar{\delta} = \frac{\delta - \delta_{tax}}{1 - \delta_{tax}}$. Then, for any $\delta_{tax} < \delta < 1$, SHIP (Algorithm 2) satisfies (ε, δ)-DP, where*

$$\varepsilon = \inf_{\alpha > 1} \left\{ \alpha\rho + \log\left(1 - \frac{1}{\alpha}\right) - \frac{\log \bar{\delta} + \log \alpha}{\alpha - 1} \right\}.$$

5 Experiments

In this section, we briefly introduce our experimental setup, including evaluation metrics, baselines, and datasets, following by our experimental results and findings. Additional implementation and experimental details are provided in Appendix B.

Evaluation Metrics. We evaluate the dataset-level statistical and analytical utility of insights through query answering, using two complementary protocols. *Deterministic QA Accuracy* (Zhang et al., 2025) evaluates targeted questions with well-defined ground-truth answers, including numerical, comparison, and yes/no questions. We further distinguish between single-feature and multi-feature questions based on the information required to answer them (see Appendix C for examples.) An offline agent built on Gemini-3.5-Flash-Lite answers each question using only the generated insight, and the response is evaluated against the ground truth on a discrete 1-5 scale using LLM-as-a-judge. *Open-Ended QA Quality* evaluates broader analytical questions that require a comprehensive answer (see Table 10). Following factuality-based evaluation (Min et al., 2023), we decompose the offline agent's reports into atomic statements and compute precision (the fraction of insight-derived statements supported by the ground truth), recall (the fraction of ground-truth statements supported by the insight), and F_1.

These two protocols provide a common basis for evaluating insights across different output formats, measuring both their ability to recover specific facts and to support higher-level analysis. For structured insights, we additionally introduce *Semantic Sinkhorn Divergence* to assess the fidelity of the extracted tabular representation (details provided in Appendix B.5). We report 1-way divergence over individual attributes and 2-way divergence over attribute pairs, capturing both marginal information and cross-attribute relationships.

Baselines. We compare SHIP with representative well-established differentially private insight generation approaches described in Section 3 and enumerated in Table 1 (see also Appendix B.) The main QA evaluation compares the workload-driven utility of representative private insight pipelines across output formats. The structured fidelity evaluation complements this comparison by examining how taxonomy construction affects information preservation within tabular representations. We therefore include the hierarchical closed- and open-set variants of SHIP, denoted Hie-Close and Hie-Open, in the structured fidelity evaluation, where they serve as controlled ablations of taxonomy construction. For all methods, we use Gemini-3.5-Flash as the taxonomy and attribute models and Gemini-3.5-Flash-Lite as the classification model.

Datasets. For query-answering evaluation, we use GenAI conversation datasets, including WildChat (Zhao et al., 2024) and SynChat, which is a synthetic human-AI conversation dataset constructed on predefined metadata and thus has deterministic ground truth. Structured insight quality is evaluated on WildChat, CFPB (CFPB, 2026), and ChatDoctor (Li et al., 2023), covering conversational, financial, and medical domains. We additionally construct SynChat_topic to study challenging queries involving variable-length structures such as within-session topic transitions.

5.1 Main Experiments

Deterministic Query-Answering Evaluation. Table 2 reports the aggregate results of deterministic query answering averaged across the workload for WildChat and SynChat. To supplement these aggregate results, we provide examples illustrating different queries and the answers obtained by different insights mechanisms in Appendix C. SHIP achieves the strongest overall performance across most tested settings, which is expected because it is specifically designed for this query-answering task. Because SHIP delivers fine-grained semantic information and cross-attribute relationships, it's able to effectively answer a wider variety of queries than alternative approaches.

The baseline results illustrate how different representations support the evaluated workload. Urania's cluster-level summaries and keyword statistics emphasize thematic patterns for exploratory analysis, offering less direct support for our analytical queries about fine-grained attributes and cross-attribute joint distributions. This helps explain its lower accuracy, particularly on multi-attribute queries. Flat-Close and Flat-Open expose explicit

Table 2: Deterministic query-answering evaluation across single- and multi-attribute questions on WildChat and SynChat under varying privacy budgets ε. We report average score (1-5 scale ↑) and accuracy (Score ≥ 4, % ↑).

ε	Algorithm	WildChat						SynChat					
		Single-Attr		Multi-Attr		Overall		Single-Attr		Multi-Attr		Overall	
		Avg Score	Acc	Avg Score	Acc	Avg Score	Acc	Avg Score	Acc	Avg Score	Acc	Avg Score	Acc
1.0	Urania	1.47	12.0	1.03	0.0	1.25	6.0	1.65	15.3	1.02	0.0	1.33	7.7
	Flat-Close	2.43	32.7	2.59	37.3	2.51	35.0	1.81	20.0	1.70	17.3	1.76	18.7
	Flat-Open	3.01	46.0	3.13	44.7	3.07	45.3	2.27	30.7	1.88	21.3	2.07	26.0
	SHIP (Ours)	**4.05**	**72.7**	**3.56**	**53.3**	**3.80**	**63.0**	**3.54**	**59.3**	**4.41**	**83.3**	**3.97**	**71.3**
5.0	Urania	1.78	19.3	1.03	0.0	1.40	9.7	2.63	38.0	1.71	18.0	2.17	28.0
	Flat-Close	2.26	29.3	3.03	48.0	2.65	38.7	1.60	14.7	1.57	13.3	1.59	14.0
	Flat-Open	2.92	43.3	**3.33**	**49.3**	3.13	46.3	2.13	28.0	2.53	36.0	2.33	32.0
	SHIP (Ours)	**3.60**	**60.0**	3.31	46.7	**3.46**	**53.3**	**3.80**	**64.7**	**4.27**	**79.3**	**4.04**	**72.0**
10.0	Urania	1.77	18.0	1.27	6.0	1.52	12.0	2.65	37.3	1.70	14.7	2.17	26.0
	Flat-Close	2.33	30.0	3.01	47.3	2.67	38.7	1.72	17.3	1.63	15.3	1.68	16.3
	Flat-Open	2.89	42.7	3.18	48.0	3.03	45.3	2.17	29.3	2.52	35.3	2.34	32.3
	SHIP (Ours)	**3.85**	**66.0**	**3.46**	**51.3**	**3.66**	**58.7**	**3.65**	**62.0**	**3.98**	**72.0**	**3.82**	**67.0**

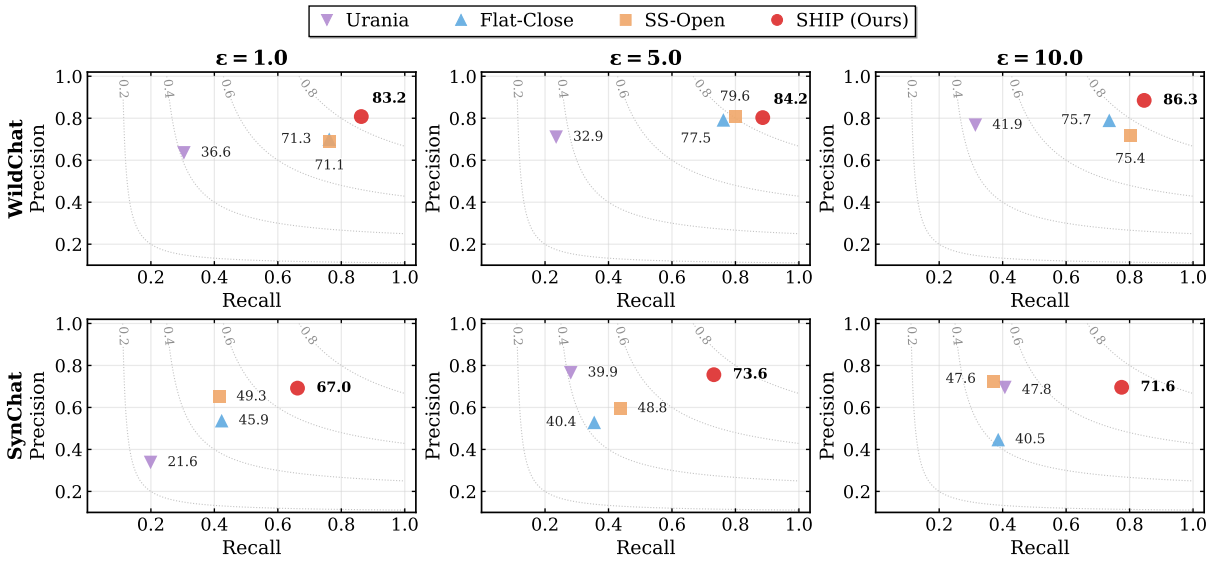


Figure 3: Precision, Recall, and F_1 in open-ended query-answering evaluation across WildChat (top row) and SynChat (bottom row) under privacy budgets $\varepsilon \in \{1, 5, 10\}$. Dotted background curves denote iso-F_1 contours.

attributes for statistical analysis, but their flat taxonomies provide less coverage of the semantic distinctions required by detailed queries.

Open-ended Query-Answering Evaluation. Figure 3 presents the results of open-ended analytical query answering across WildChat and SynChat. The reports generated from several baseline resources achieve relatively high precision but substantially lower recall, indicating that they capture only a subset of the reference findings. For example, on WildChat at $\varepsilon = 1.0$, Urania achieves 63.5% precision and 30.4% recall. Similarly, on Synchat at $\varepsilon = 1.0$, Flat-Open achieves 65.1% precision and 41.6% recall. The low recalls indicate that some important conclusions for queries that we can obtain from ground truth are not captured by these insights.

SHIP achieves broader coverage: on WildChat, its recall consistently ranges from 84.0% to 89.0%, while on SynChat it also achieves substantially higher recall than the competing methods. This pattern is consistent with the complementary information made available by its integrated design, which combines hierarchical hybrid taxonomy construction with private tabular synthesis to expose fine-grained semantic categories and cross-attribute relationships. Together with its precision scores, this broader coverage yields the highest F_1

Table 3: Non-DP comparison ($\varepsilon = \infty$) between Urania and SHIP on WildChat and SynChat. Closed-ended QA reports overall average score (1-5 scale) and accuracy (percentage of questions with score ≥ 4); open-ended QA reports five-round precision, recall, and F1 (%).

Algorithm	WildChat					SynChat				
	Closed-Ended QA		Open-Ended QA			Closed-Ended QA		Open-Ended QA		
	Score	Acc (%)	Precision	Recall	F_1	Score	Acc (%)	Precision	Recall	F_1
Urania	2.17	27.0	65.5	43.2	47.8	2.56	36.3	**86.8**	56.0	66.6
SHIP (Ours)	**4.00**	**69.3**	**94.3**	**95.0**	**94.4**	**3.90**	**67.7**	78.8	**65.5**	**70.7**

Table 4: Distribution fidelity (Sinkhorn divergence ↓) across datasets under varying privacy budgets ε.

ε	Algorithm	CFPB		ChatDoctor		WildChat	
		1-way Div ↓	2-way Div ↓	1-way Div ↓	2-way Div ↓	1-way Div ↓	2-way Div ↓
1.0	Flat-Close	0.2215	0.3469	0.1142	0.1917	0.1696	0.2966
	Flat-Open	0.1581	0.2529	0.1178	0.1831	0.1581	0.2585
	Hie-Close	0.1465	0.2182	**0.0745**	0.1139	0.1564	0.2353
	Hie-Open	0.1314	0.1980	0.0900	0.1396	0.1324	0.2155
	SHIP (Ours)	**0.1313**	**0.1896**	0.0762	**0.1129**	**0.1201**	**0.1942**
5.0	Flat-Close	0.2219	0.3473	0.1142	0.1915	0.1697	0.2966
	Flat-Open	0.1563	0.2483	0.1167	0.1815	0.1570	0.2564
	Hie-Close	0.1472	0.2198	0.0746	0.1141	0.1565	0.2355
	Hie-Open	**0.1132**	0.1675	0.0833	0.1286	0.1246	0.2023
	SHIP (Ours)	0.1143	**0.1652**	**0.0744**	**0.1104**	**0.1192**	**0.1915**
10.0	Flat-Close	0.2219	0.3472	0.1143	0.1916	0.1697	0.2967
	Flat-Open	0.1553	0.2460	0.1165	0.1809	0.1574	0.2569
	Hie-Close	0.1474	0.2200	**0.0746**	0.1141	0.1564	0.2354
	Hie-Open	**0.1037**	**0.1534**	0.0810	0.1247	0.1217	0.1973
	SHIP (Ours)	0.1114	0.1630	0.0755	**0.1133**	**0.1175**	**0.1876**

scores across all evaluation settings, indicating the strongest combined performance on factual correctness and finding coverage.

Non-DP QA comparison. To better understand how cluster-based and structured insights support query answering, we further compare SHIP and Urania (which reduces to Clio in this setting) in the non-private setting. Table 3 provides two key observations. First, although Urania benefits from removing DP noise, its QA performance remains relatively limited, while SHIP continues to achieve better overall results. This suggests that cluster-based insights, which are primarily designed for high-level data exploration, may be less effective at supporting fine-grained analytical queries. Second, while SHIP also benefits from removing DP noise in some cases, the improvements are relatively modest, suggesting that privacy noise is not the only factor limiting its performance. We hypothesize that other sources of error, such as uncertainty in LLM-based annotation and agent-based evaluation, may also contribute to the remaining performance gap.

Structured Insight Fidelity Evaluation. Finally, we compare the synthetic structured insight with structured insights generated by other structured insight paradigms, shown in Table 4. First, the empirical results demonstrate that hierarchical approaches are more effective than flat structures at preserving the original data distribution. Comparing the flat algorithms (Flat-Close and Flat-Open) with the hierarchical algorithms (Hie-Close, Hie-Open, and our proposed SHIP), we observe that the flat baselines consistently yield higher divergences across all datasets and privacy budgets.

Second, among hierarchical approaches, no single open- or closed-set strategy dominates across all datasets and privacy budgets. Hie-Close relies on model priors for taxonomy construction, yielding stable categories but limiting data-adaptive discovery. For instance, on CFPB, its 1-way divergence remains around 0.14 as the privacy budget increases, but SHIP's decreases from 0.13 to 0.11. In contrast, Hie-Open adapts its categories directly to the private data, but becomes more sensitive to small privacy budgets because low-frequency

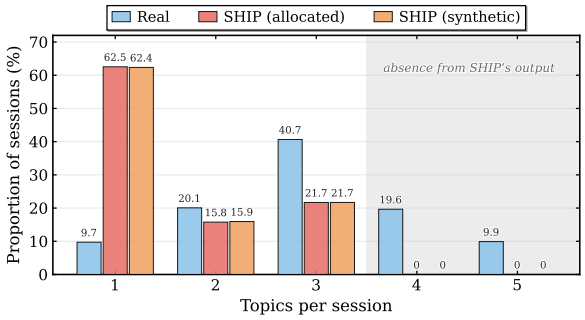


Figure 4: Distribution of the number of topics per session in SynChat_topic, obtained from real dataset and SHIP ($\varepsilon = 10$). "Allocated" is SHIP's per-record category assignment, "synthetic" refers to the output of its DP tabular synthesizer.

categories are harder to recover through private discovery. This effect is more pronounced on diverse datasets such as WildChat and ChatDoctor. By combining data-driven discovery with prior-based supplementation, SHIP provides a more robust compromise.

5.2 Challenging Queries for SHIP

We further examine queries that are difficult for SHIP to answer correctly. On SynChat_topic, where conversations may traverse multiple topics, we ask SHIP to capture each session's topic-switching path at $\varepsilon = 10$. As shown in Figure 4, the released distribution is biased toward shorter paths and fails to recover longer sequences. This discrepancy arises before tabular synthesis: variable-length paths yield a large, sparse categorical domain, making long sequences difficult to recover via private domain discovery, while prior-based completion is also ill-suited to such highly data-dependent combinations.

This example highlights the importance of matching the insight representation to the structure required by the analytical workload. Encoding complete sequences as atomic categories can make private discovery difficult, even when their constituent topics are common. More broadly, workloads involving ordering, relationships between entities, or open-ended compositional patterns motivate representations that preserve these structures without requiring every complete configuration to be discovered as a separate category. Exploring such representations is a promising direction for extending private insight generation to a broader range of analytical workloads.

6 Conclusion

In this work, we study DP insight extraction from textual corpora through a query-answering perspective. We introduce SHIP, a framework for extracting structured insights under DP, and develop a unified evaluation protocol that measures how well different insight representations support common analytical needs. Our experiments show that structured insights can provide strong query-answering utility and also identify queries that remain challenging for current insight-generation paradigms, highlighting opportunities for richer representations and extraction mechanisms. We hope this work provides a common basis for developing and evaluating future private insight systems.

Limitations

Our work has two main limitations. First, our query evaluation focuses primarily on dataset-level statistical and analytical queries, including counting, comparison, aggregation, and multi-attribute analysis, and does not establish effectiveness for arbitrary queries. Even within this scope, our experiments identify queries that SHIP's current DP structured representation does not support well, such as those involving long topic-switching sequences. These findings highlight the need for alternative representations or extraction mechanisms when the required information is difficult to capture through categorical attributes.

Second, we evaluate insights primarily through their ability to answer a specified analytical workload. This captures one dimension of utility and does not establish SHIP's superiority across all aspects of data analysis; other representations may offer complementary benefits beyond this evaluation. Moreover, both our ground-truth annotations and SHIP also use three-level taxonomies, which may favor SHIP in reference-based comparisons. We have not quantified this potential bias. Future work should assess robustness to alternative taxonomy depths and reference schemas, alongside broader analytical benefits such as discovering unanticipated patterns and supporting evolving information needs.

Ethical Considerations

Our experiments use publicly available datasets and synthetically generated data, without collecting additional private user data. SHIP is intended to support aggregate analysis rather than identify

individual users. We do not release identifiable user records or information, and the insights released by SHIP are generated under DP.

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A Supplementary Related Work

In this section, we discuss more about the relationship between SHIP and other related works, mainly including concurrent insight work, DP text analysis, and DP synthetic data generation.

Concurrent Private Insight Works. There are some concurrent works about DP insight generation from unstructured text. DP-SPIN (Razeghi, 2026) releases noisy aggregate statistics over predefined semantic concepts and uses them to guide LLM-generated summaries. CALLIOPE (Cohen et al., 2026) is similar to our approach, prompting an LLM to discover topic hierarchies and conducting partition selection to guarantee DP.

Related Text Analytics Paradigms. RAG-based methods answer queries by retrieving relevant passages from the underlying corpus, with recent work extending this paradigm to private retrieval (Koga et al., 2025; Wu et al., 2025; Mori et al., 2026) and large-scale conversational analysis (Zhang et al., 2025). Structured analytics systems instead use Text-to-SQL, semantic operators, or taxonomy induction to execute analytical workloads over unstructured data (Yu et al., 2019; Lam et al., 2024; Patel et al., 2025; Anderson et al., 2024; Shankar

Table 5: The summary of four investigated datasets. Mid-tokens refer to the median number of tokens, and 95%-tokens mean the 95% percentile of token numbers. The token size statistics are calculated using `Sentence-T5-base`.

Dataset	Records	Mid-Tokens	95%-Tokens	Open-ended Workload
WildChat	838k	1,061	4,463	{What are the users' primary task intents and topic domains, what specific constraints or output formatting requirements are requested, and what types of solutions or response strategies do the assistants provide to resolve the requests?}
ChatDoctor	112k	252	531	{What are the users' primary symptoms and chief complaints, and for those symptoms, what diagnostic tests or examinations do the doctors suggest, and what are the doctors' diagnosis conclusions?}
CFPB	10k	192	885	{What are the primary problems or grievances encountered by the users, and what specific inquiries, requests, or corrective actions do the users seek to resolve the issues?}
SynChat	10k	217	636	[Same as WildChat]
SynChat_topic	10k	532	879	{Which topics come up in each conversation session? For sessions covering several topics, what are the most common complete paths from the first topic to the last, and how often does each occur?}

et al., 2025; Sadia et al., 2026). Unlike these query-time analysis paradigms, we focus on releasing a reusable insight representation under DP, which can support various downstream anaysis.

DP Synthetic Text Generation. Recent DP synthetic text frameworks achieve state-of-the-art utility by extracting structured insights as an intermediate representation rather than replacing direct insight extraction. Specifically, ACTG-ARL (Hu et al., 2025) and MAPLE (Chien et al., 2026) leverage the structured insights to steer DP fine-tuning or private evolution to generate synthetic text. DP synthetic text generation targets a broader release that can support downstream tasks beyond a predefined analytical workload, whereas we focus on compact representations for data insight. The two directions are therefore complementary.

B Detailed Experimental Settings

B.1 Detailed Implementation of SHIP

Detailed Taxonomy Building. We provide a complete version of Algorithm 1 here in Algorithm 3. It introduces how we conduct the private partition selection to discover categories and allocate supplementary categories after that. There are several main differences between it and Algorithm 1.

First, we will skip those parent categories that are "none" or "other", which refer to the case that the attribute is not mentioned or the real category is too rare, respectively. After allocation, all filtered categories will be renamed to "other" as a default category. Second, we have a filter threshold for supplementary categories in order to reduce domain complexity. In our experiment, we set $\tau_{\text{close}} = 10$ for simplicity. Finally, we also utilize an LLM to de-duplicate and refine categories across levels. Because this step is performed after private category selection at each level, it does not consume any privacy budget.

Detailed Privacy Budget Split. Given a target (ε, δ)-DP guarantee, we set the privacy parameters $(\rho_{\text{aim}}, \rho_{\text{tax}}, \delta_{\text{tax}})$ in Algorithm 2 as follows:

$$\delta_{\text{tax}} = \delta/3,$$
$$\rho_{\text{aim}} = \rho_{\text{tax}} = \frac{1}{2} f_\rho(\varepsilon, 2\delta/3),$$

Here, f_ρ numerically inverts the zCDP-to-DP conversion to obtain a zCDP budget compatible with the target DP parameters.

B.2 Detailed Baseline Introduction

In our work, we mainly consider 5 insight algorithms that can provide strict DP guarantees. We acknowledge that there are other algorithms, but most of them cannot provide DP protection during their pipelines, so we omit them in our experiments. Here is a detailed introduction to them, including introduction and implementation details.

- **Urania.** We adapt the original Urania (Liu et al., 2025) into a workload-aware baseline for a fair comparison. First, an LLM extracts candidate

Algorithm 3: Complete Hierarchical Hybrid DP Taxonomy Building

Input: Records $\mathcal{D} = \{x_1, \ldots, x_N\}$, Dataset description S_D, Max depth d, Attribute A, Privacy parameters $(\rho_{\text{step}}, \delta_{\text{step}})$, Taxonomy model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{tax}}$, Classification model $\mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}$.

Output: Taxonomy $\mathcal{T}_A$, Internal record paths $\{y_i\}_{i=1}^N$.

$\rho_{\text{open}} = 0.9\rho_{\text{step}}, \quad \rho_{\text{close}} = 0.1\rho_{\text{step}}$;

$\sigma_{\text{open}} = 1/\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{open}}}, \quad \sigma_{\text{close}} = 1/\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{close}}}$;

Compute τ_{open} and τ_{close};

Initialize tree-like domain Ω_A with root $\perp$;

for $l \leftarrow 1$ **to** d, *each level* $l-1$ *category* c_p *in* Ω_A **do**

  Skip if c_p is `other` or `none`;

  $\mathcal{D}_p \leftarrow$ records assigned to c_p;

  foreach $x_i \in \mathcal{D}_p$ **do**

    $y_i \leftarrow \mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}(x_i, A, c_p)$;

  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{open}} \leftarrow \emptyset$;

  foreach $c \in \{y_i\}_{x_i \in \mathcal{D}_p}$ **do**

    $\tilde{n}_c \leftarrow \sum_i \mathbf{1}\{y_i = c\} + \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2_{\text{open}})$;

    if $\tilde{n}_c \geq \tau_{open}(\sigma_{open}, \delta_{step})$ **then**

      $\mathcal{C}_{\text{open}} \leftarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{open}} \cup \{c\}$;

  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{comp}} \leftarrow \mathcal{M}_{\text{tax}}(A, S_D, c_p, \mathcal{C}_{\text{open}})$;

  foreach $x_i \in \mathcal{D}_p$ **do**

    if $y_i \notin \mathcal{C}_{open}$ **then**

      $y_i \leftarrow \mathcal{M}_{\text{cls}}(x_i, \mathcal{C}_{\text{open}} \cup \mathcal{C}_{\text{comp}})$;

  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}} \leftarrow \{\texttt{other}\}$;

  foreach $c \in \mathcal{C}_{open} \cup \mathcal{C}_{comp}$ **do**

    $\tilde{n}_c \leftarrow \sum_i \mathbf{1}\{y_i = c\} + \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2_{\text{close}})$;

    if $\tilde{n}_c \geq \tau_{close}$ **then**

      $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}} \leftarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}} \cup \{c\}$;

  Map excluded assignments to `other`;

  De-duplicate and refine categories in $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}}$;

  Add $\mathcal{C}_{\text{surv}}$ as children of c_p in Ω_A and allocate $\mathcal{D}_p$ using $\{y_i\}$;

return $\{A : \Omega_A\}, \{y_i\}_{i=1}^N$;

keywords (single words or short phrases) and generates a summary for each record, guided by the workload. DP partition selection is then applied to privately select keywords from the extracted candidates. Next, sentence embeddings of the record summaries are computed and clustered using DP k-means. Here, we further extend DP k-means to hierarchical clustering for finer-grained results. For each cluster, a DP keyword histogram is constructed. Finally, an LLM generates cluster titles and high-level descriptions conditioned on the workload, DP-protected keyword statistics, and child cluster information.

- **Flat-Close.** This approach represents a set of methods, including non-DP structured insight extraction used by OpenAI (Chatterji et al., 2025) and DP structured metadata synthesis used in Hu et al.'s work (Hu et al., 2025). In this method, we first define a taxonomy by an LLM without any access to the raw data, and annotate each record. Finally, a tabular synthesis mechanism is employed to output a private structured insight.

- **Flat-Open.** This baseline serves as a direct extension of existing open-set structured summarization methods (Cheu et al., 2025). Existing literature predominantly formulates open-set discovery along isolated attribute dimensions, releasing categories that survive differential private partition selection alongside independent 1-dimensional noisy histograms. To preserve baseline fidelity without introducing ad-hoc synthetic modeling unstudied in prior work, our implementation evaluates each attribute independently and constructs multi-attribute insights via separate marginal releases. This faithful setting directly captures the structural limitations of current open-set approaches when applied to joint, multi-attribute analytical workloads.

- **Hie-Close & Hie-Open.** These two baselines are variants of SHIP. Hie-Close relies completely on a pre-defined taxonomy by removing the open discovery step in SHIP, and Hie-Open discovers categories only by partition selection by removing the closed supplementary category generation step in SHIP.

B.3 Datasets Information

There are five datasets investigated in our experiments, including three real-world datasets and two artificial datasets. For workload, we generate most content-related queries and form the workload descriptions. A summarization is provided in Table 5. Following established text-insight systems that rely on subsampling to reconcile large-scale corpora with LLM API token limits (e.g., Clio (Tamkin et al., 2024) and Urania (Liu et al., 2025)), we

apply uniform Poisson subsampling on corpora exceeding 100k records (sampling ratios $r = 2\%$ for WildChat and $r = 10\%$ for ChatDoctor). Beyond computational feasibility, Poisson subsampling is theoretically grounded in differential privacy via privacy amplification by subsampling (Balle et al., 2018): executing an $(\epsilon_{\text{sub}}, \delta_{\text{sub}})$-DP mechanism on a Poisson subsample with sampling ratio r satisfies global (ϵ, δ)-DP on the full corpus, where $\epsilon = \ln(1 + r(e^{\epsilon_{\text{sub}}} - 1))$ and $\delta = r \cdot \delta_{\text{sub}}$. The reported privacy parameter ϵ denotes the unified global end-to-end privacy budget.

The two artificial datasets are generated label-first: we sample the ground truth and then synthesize text conditioned on it, so the true annotation of every record is known by construction rather than estimated after the fact. The pipeline has three stages. First, for each annotation attribute, an LLM builds a hierarchical taxonomy from the attribute description and a description of the target corpus, which we optionally prune. Second, we sample each record's ground-truth labels from that taxonomy under a controlled distribution; this is the only stage at which the two corpora differ. SynChat draws one hierarchical category path per attribute, autoregressively conditioned on an anchor attribute, so that correlations between attributes are planted rather than incidental. SynChat_topic instead draws a sequence of leaves per record, a walk whose length is drawn from an explicit distribution and whose steps follow a transition matrix we control, so that a conversation changes topic a known number of times and in a known direction. Finally, an LLM renders the sampled labels into a conversation.

B.4 QA Metric Introduction

Workload Access. We assume that all methods have the same access to the workload files during insight generation, which are shown in Table 5.

Auxiliary Agent. To perform closed-loop evaluation, we deploy an auxiliary agent implemented on the Antigravity SDK (Google DeepMind, 2026) with the Gemini-3.5-Flash-Lite model. The agent is explicitly constrained to operate in a controlled offline setting: default capabilities and external retrieval tools are completely masked, leaving only an isolated Python execution environment with bounded file access to prevent data leakage and ensure fair benchmarking.

Deterministic QA. Deterministic evaluation queries are generated by our auxiliary agent from structured summaries of the raw text. Following prior work (Zhang et al., 2025), we first apply a non-DP summarization algorithm to distill the raw corpus. Conditioned on an open-ended user intent, the agent generates deterministic queries paired with canonical ground-truth answers. Specifically, we generate 100 queries across each of three distinct question types: *Yes/No*, *Comparative*, *Numerical*, with each type evenly partitioned between single-feature and multi-feature queries. This yields 300 deterministic queries per dataset. Several examples are shown in Table 6.

For WildChat, since we do not have ground-truth metadata, we generate it using an LLM-summarization algorithm. Each record is independently categorized using a powerful LLM, and all categories are aggregated and de-duplicated. We also conduct this process in a hierarchical structure. We acknowledge that this process may introduce bias due to pipeline design, model capacity, and randomness, which is also a limitation of prior work (Zhang et al., 2025).

The queries are answered using an offline agent. The agent is provided with the full set of generated insight artifacts and tasked with answering each benchmark query through closed-loop data inspection. To evaluate correctness, an LLM judge compares the agent's predicted response against the predefined ground-truth answer, assigning a discrete score on a 1-to-5 scale. Because these queries have standard and deterministic answers, we only evaluate once for each algorithm.

Open-Ended QA. The pipeline of open-ended QA evaluation is a symmetric, two-pass verification process designed to assess both the completeness and factual fidelity of dataset summarizations. In the first pass (Recall), an autonomous code agent synthesizes a comprehensive analytical report from the ground-truth summarization conditioned on a workload query, which is subsequently decomposed into independent atomic factual statements. These ground-truth statements are then validated against the target summarization by executing closed-loop verification code on the target data files, calculating the proportion of ground-truth findings accurately captured (Recall). Symmetrically, in the second pass (Precision), the agent generates an analytical report directly from the target summarization, decomposes it into candidate statements, and validates them against the ground truth to quantify the factual accuracy of the target's conclusions (Precision). Finally, the F1 score is

Table 6: Several examples of deterministic queries on SynChat with standard answers. We present one example for each query category (single- or multi-attributes $\times$ query type).

Category	Query Content
Single-Attribute Yes/No	**Query:** Across all user interactions, do direct information retrieval and text transformation tasks collectively constitute more than 65% of all primary user intents? **Answer:** Yes.
Single-Attribute Comparison	**Query:** Across user conversation intents, do users more frequently ask the assistant to modify, summarize, or transform existing text, or to generate original creative writing pieces? **Answer:** Transforming and modifying existing text.
Single-Attribute Ask for Number	**Query:** Within user requests aimed at modifying and transforming existing text, what proportion specifically request content summarization into condensed formats such as bullet point extractions, executive summaries, or single-sentence abstracts? **Answer:** 0.3994 (39.94%).
Multi-Attribute Yes/No	**Query:** Among user requests focused on software coding tasks (such as code generation, bug fixing, performance optimization, and unit testing), does the computer programming topic domain account for more than 35% of all conversations? **Answer:** Yes.
Multi-Attribute Comparison	**Query:** When users engage with topics in computer programming, do their requests more frequently involve text transformation tasks (such as summarization, translation, paraphrasing, and proofreading) or creative writing tasks (such as narrative fiction, poetry, scriptwriting, and roleplay)? **Answer:** Text transformation tasks.
Multi-Attribute Ask for Number	**Query:** In discussions focused on the mathematics domain (covering geometry, calculus, number theory, and probability and statistics), what proportion of assistant responses adopt a clarification-seeking strategy (such as disambiguation, slot filling, preference elicitation, or intent confirmation)? **Answer:** 0.2003 (20.03%).

computed to provide a unified benchmark score balancing insight coverage and factual grounding. We set the LLM temperature to 0 to reduce generation variability. To account for residual variability observed in long-form analytical reports, we run the open-ended QA evaluation five times on the released insights and report the average scores.

B.5 Textual Table Sinkhorn Divergence.

To evaluate how faithfully the synthetic table $\mathcal{D}_{\text{syn}}$ preserves the categorical distributions and attribute correlations of the ground-truth table $\mathcal{D}_{\text{real}}$, we measure the semantic distance between empirical distributions via entropic optimal transport. Note that here, to make our ground-truth $\mathcal{D}_{\text{real}}$ more accurate, we use phrases or sentences summarized by an LLM as its categories.

For a given attribute (or attribute pair in 2-way divergence evaluation), let $\mathbf{p}$ and $\mathbf{q}$ denote the empirical category frequency distributions over unique vocabularies. We map categories into dense semantic representations and construct a ground cost matrix $\mathbf{C} \in [0,1]^{m\times n}$ via normalized cosine distance,

$$C_{ij} = 1 - \frac{1}{2}(\cos(e_i, e_j) + 1).$$

For two-way divergence, we define

$$C_{ij} = 1 - \frac{1}{4}(\cos(e_i^{(1)}, e_j^{(1)}) + 1)(\cos(e_i^{(2)}, e_j^{(2)}) + 1).$$

We then compute the entropic optimal transport cost:

$$\mathcal{W}_\varepsilon(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{q}) = \min_{\mathbf{T}\in\Pi(\mathbf{p},\mathbf{q})} \langle \mathbf{T}, \mathbf{C}\rangle - \varepsilon H(\mathbf{T}),$$

where $\Pi(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{q})$ is the transport polytope and $H(\mathbf{T})$ is the entropy regularizer ($\varepsilon = 0.1$). To eliminate entropic self-bias, we report the debiased Sinkhorn divergence:

$$\mathcal{S}_\varepsilon(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{q}) = \mathcal{W}_\varepsilon(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{q}) - \frac{1}{2}\mathcal{W}_\varepsilon(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{p}) - \frac{1}{2}\mathcal{W}_\varepsilon(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{q}).$$

We evaluate $\mathcal{S}_\varepsilon$ across both 1-column marginal distributions and 2-column joint attribute distributions, reporting the average score across columns (lower indicates superior distributional alignment).

Table 7: Case study from SynChat ($\varepsilon = 10$) illustrating categorization across algorithms. SHIP discovers hierarchical paths across all four orthogonal dimensions, whereas `Flat-Close` and `Flat-Open` use 1-level labels, and `Urania` outputs an unstructured text cluster descriptor.

Raw Dialogue	**Algorithm & Categorization**
user: Can you proofread this calculus passage and fix the punctuation errors, while also organizing your final explanations using a markdown table? Here is the draft: The derivative in differential calculus measures the rate of change. It derives from the Latin word differentia meaning difference. **ai**: Here is the corrected text with proper punctuation, followed by a breakdown of the etymological origin presented as a markdown table: The derivative, in differential calculus, measures the rate of change. It derives from the Latin word **differentia**, meaning difference. | Term | Language of Origin | Etymological Meaning | | :— | :— | :— | | Derivative | Latin (*derivativus*) | To draw off, lead down, or derive from a source | | Differential | Latin (*differentia*) | A variance, distinction, or difference between quantities | **user**: That table is very clear, thank you. Could you double-check if any extra punctuation marks are missing around the word differentia? **ai**: The punctuation is correct as written. To be thorough, the term differential calculus itself originates from the Latin **differentia**, where the root relates to the infinitesimal differences studied in calculus.	**Ground Truth** • Intent: `text transformation > proofreading > punctuation correction` • Topic: `mathematics > calculus > differential calculus` • Constraint: `output_format > tabular_format > markdown_table` • Strategy: `direct_information > factual_definition > etymological_origin` **SHIP** • Intent: `text editing > proofreading & correction > punctuation correction` • Topic: `stem > mathematics in stem > mathematical calculus` • Constraint: `formatting and structure > tabular formatting > markdown table` • Strategy: `direct answer > correction > linguistic correction` **Flat-Close** • Intent: `text processing` • Topic: `stem` • Constraint: `formatting and structure` • Strategy: `structured presentation` **Flat-Open** • Intent: `text editing` • Topic: `stem` • Constraint: `formatting` • Strategy: `step-by-step explanation` **Urania** • Cluster: `Technical, Academic, and Creative Tasks with Output Constraints` • Keywords: `markdown table, unit testing, algebraic number theory, ...` • Description: `This cluster encompasses a wide variety of user requests across technical, academic, linguistic, and creative domains, including web development, algebraic number theory, literal translation, and character development. Users frequently impose explicit structural and stylistic constraints ...`

B.6 Implementation Details

We implement SHIP with depth $d = 3$ by default. We set $\tau_{\text{close}} = 10$ for simplicity. All algorithms are implemented on the Gemini API. We use Gemini-3.5-Flash-Lite for all classification and keyword extraction tasks, and use Gemini-3.5-Flash as taxonomy generators. The supplementary categories are generated via Simula (Davidson et al., 2026). For all algorithm, we set global $\varepsilon in \{1, 5, 10\}$ and $\delta = 1/(n \ln(n))$.

C Supplementary Experiment Results

C.1 Examples of Categorization

In Table 7, we present a raw data record with its ground-truth meta data and the categorization results obtained from different algorithms ($\varepsilon = 1$). From this table, the first observation is that SHIP provides a more granular classification than Flat-Open and Flat-Close. For instance, SHIP propose "mathematical calculus" as the topic, while Flat-Open and Flat-Close only categorize the data into "STEM".

In terms of Urania, we can observe that the clus-

Table 8: Case studies of deterministic query evaluation on SynChat ($\varepsilon = 10$) across different structural paradigms. We provide representative examples: (1) *Macro Shallow Query*: Top-level distributions are accurately captured by all methods. (2) *Hierarchical Query*: Fine-grained subcategories are correctly resolved by SHIP via hierarchical taxonomy, whereas flat baselines collapse and fail. (3) *Cross-Attribute Joint Query*: Tabular representations with orthogonal attribute axes (SHIP and `Flat-Close`) accurately evaluate bivariate cross-tabulations, whereas 1D semantic clustering (`Urania`) entangles dimensions and fails. (4) *Highly Detailed Query*: Excessively fine-grained joint conditions lead to failure across all methods.

Query & Ground Truth	**SHIP (Ours)**	**Flat-Close**	**Flat-Open**	**Urania**
Query: Across the entire dataset, when users specify constraints on their requests, do they more frequently demand specific output formatting requirements or enforce explicit length limits? **Answer:** Output formatting	**Formatting rules** **Score: 5/5** ✓	**Formatting rules** **Score: 5/5** ✓	**Formatting rules** **Score: 5/5** ✓	**Formatting rules** **Score: 5/5** ✓
Query: Within web development conversations in computer programming, what proportion of user requests specify tabular presentation formats in their output constraints? **Answer:** 16.07%	**15.91%** **Score: 5/5** ✓	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×
Query: Across user requests with a primary intent of software coding, what proportion specify output format constraints? **Answer:** 41.77%	**43.15%** **Score: 5/5** ✓	**39.80%** **Score: 5/5** ✓	**21.40%** **Score: 2/5** ×	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×
Query: Within calculus topic discussions under mathematics, what proportion of queries focus specifically on differential calculus and derivative operations? **Answer:** 3.17%	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×	*"I don't know"* **Score: 1/5** ×

Table 9: Open-ended query-answering evaluation across analytical conclusion statements on WildChat and SynChat under varying privacy budgets ε. We report Recall (Score ≥ 4, % ↑), Precision (Score ≥ 4, % ↑), and primary F_1 score (Score ≥ 4, % ↑), together with their standard deviations.

ε	**Algorithm**	**WildChat**			**SynChat**		
		Recall	Precision	F_1	Recall	Precision	F_1
1.0	`Urania`	$30.4_{\pm 17.3}$	$63.5_{\pm 19.5}$	$36.6_{\pm 20.6}$	$19.9_{\pm 16.6}$	$33.8_{\pm 11.3}$	$21.6_{\pm 14.2}$
	`Flat-Close`	$76.2_{\pm 10.4}$	$70.0_{\pm 17.3}$	$71.3_{\pm 10.0}$	$42.3_{\pm 14.6}$	$53.7_{\pm 5.3}$	$45.9_{\pm 8.7}$
	`Flat-Open`	$76.4_{\pm 9.0}$	$68.9_{\pm 17.7}$	$71.1_{\pm 12.7}$	$41.6_{\pm 13.8}$	$65.1_{\pm 16.8}$	$49.3_{\pm 13.1}$
	SHIP (Ours)	**86.3**±5.1	**80.8**±8.5	**83.2**±4.5	**66.2**±12.9	**69.2**±14.3	**67.0**±11.7
5.0	`Urania`	$23.5_{\pm 15.4}$	$71.0_{\pm 16.0}$	$32.9_{\pm 20.4}$	$28.1_{\pm 11.1}$	**76.5**±11.0	39.9±12.8
	`Flat-Close`	$76.2_{\pm 9.5}$	$79.2_{\pm 7.8}$	$77.5_{\pm 7.8}$	$35.5_{\pm 20.0}$	$52.9_{\pm 8.0}$	$40.4_{\pm 16.4}$
	`Flat-Open`	$79.9_{\pm 6.0}$	**80.6**±16.1	79.6±9.8	$43.8_{\pm 7.5}$	$59.5_{\pm 15.9}$	$48.8_{\pm 5.9}$
	SHIP (Ours)	**88.6**±7.3	80.3±5.3	**84.2**±5.9	**73.2**±8.3	$75.6_{\pm 7.2}$	**73.6**$_{\pm 2.1}$
10.0	`Urania`	$31.4_{\pm 18.3}$	$76.7_{\pm 13.9}$	$41.9_{\pm 17.5}$	$40.7_{\pm 16.5}$	$69.5_{\pm 12.6}$	$47.8_{\pm 10.2}$
	`Flat-Close`	$73.6_{\pm 13.3}$	$79.0_{\pm 7.6}$	$75.7_{\pm 9.1}$	$38.6_{\pm 11.9}$	$44.7_{\pm 6.8}$	$40.5_{\pm 8.7}$
	`Flat-Open`	$80.3_{\pm 6.0}$	$72.0_{\pm 9.4}$	$75.4_{\pm 5.9}$	$37.0_{\pm 14.7}$	**72.2**±9.0	47.6±14.1
	SHIP (Ours)	**84.6**±1.5	**88.5**±9.5	**86.3**±5.3	**77.5**±12.5	$69.6_{\pm 10.2}$	**71.6**$_{\pm 3.1}$

ter information has its own strengths and weaknesses. It can identify "differential geometry and calculus", which is a key information that all other algorithms do not include. However, the cluster also contain some necessary information, such as translation and backend development. We believe this is a core limitation of cluster-based approaches, which cannot distinguish semantically similar records.

C.2 Deterministic QA Results

We provide several representative examples in Table 8 to help illustrate the capacity of different approaches. The first query is asking about macro information, which can be easily answered by all methods. The second query is asking for detailed

Table 10: Compacted analytical reports generated by SHIP and `Flat-Close` ($\varepsilon = 10.0$) on SynChat and representative extracted atomic statements (Round 1 of evaluation). We showcase representative statements demonstrating macro distributions, fine-grained leaf details, and cross-attribute interactions.

Generated Report (Compacted)	**Extracted Statement Examples**

SHIP:
`## Executive Summary`
`Empirical investigation reveals a structured ecosystem of user inquiries, cognitive intents, domain distributions, and assistant strategies ...`
`## Macro Domain Breakdown`
`* **User Intent:** Anchored in **Information Seeking** (≈ 43%), followed by **Text Editing** (≈ 22%), **Creative Writing** (≈ 18%), and **Coding** (≈ 15%) ...`
`## In-Depth Single- & Multi-Attribute Analysis`
`* **Intent-Domain Synergy:** STEM-driven information seeking represents the single largest cross-attribute intersection in the dataset ...`
`## Strategic Takeaways`
`1. **Technical Specialization:** STEM (≈ 68%) and Information Seeking (≈ 43%) mandate rigorous factual verification and step-by-step derivations ...`
	• Information seeking accounts for roughly 43% of all conversational interactions.
	• STEM disciplines command roughly 68% of all inquiries.
	• Within computer science topics, software engineering and database administration dominate the volumetric load.
	• In mathematics, geometry and calculus inquiries drive detailed analytical requests.
	• STEM-driven information seeking represents the single largest intersection in the dataset.
	• Technical coding tasks frequently incorporate rigorous formatting constraints, such as requiring code blocks or diff patches, alongside computational constraints.
	... (69 total decomposed statements)

Flat-Close:
`## Executive Summary`
`Investigation into chat conversations reveals dialogues spanning cognitive goals, thematic domains, and operational constraints ...`
`## Macro Domain Breakdown`
`* **User Intent:** Information seeking and content generation represent the dominant volume drivers, accounting for nearly half of all prompts ...`
`## In-Depth Single- & Multi-Attribute Analysis`
`* **Cross-Tabulation:** Coding prompts within STEM almost universally trigger executable code delivery with step-by-step debugging explanations ...`
`## Strategic Takeaways`
`1. **Programmable Interfaces:** High prevalence of formatting constraints indicates users view chat assistants as programmable tools ...`
	• Information seeking and content generation represent the most dominant volume drivers, accounting for nearly half of all user prompts.
	• Technical and professional domains (STEM and productivity) dominate the thematic distribution across topical domains.
	• Formatting and structure constraints, such as markdown tables and JSON schemas, represent a major constraint category.
	• When users initiate programming tasks within the STEM domain, assistants almost universally respond with executable code blocks and step-by-step explanations.
	• Creative or professional writing within business or humanities simultaneously invokes tone/style and length constraints in roughly two-thirds of cases.
	... (59 total decomposed statements)

information, and thus only SHIP provides a relatively accuracte answer. The third query is a cross-attribute query. Therefore, only methods that have strict tabular modeling can answer it. The final example is a highly detailed query. This query is asking a tailor distribution information under a sub-category, which is overly detailed than the capacity of any methods. Therefore, all methods fail to return an accurate answer.

C.3 Open-Ended QA Results

The full numerical results of Figure 3 are provided in Table 9. To better illustrate how we conduct the open-ended QA evaluation, we present several open-ended query answer report examples and the statements extracted from them in Table 10 and Table 11.

As reflected in the reports and extracted statements, each method captures different structural characteristics of the conversational dataset. SHIP provides high-level macro distributions across orthogonal axes (e.g., Information Seeking at $\approx 43\%$, STEM disciplines at $\approx 68\%$), resolves fine-grained subcategories within hierarchical leaves (e.g., software engineering and database administration under computer science; geometry and calculus under mathematics), and delineates bivariate cross-attribute intersections (e.g., STEM-driven information seeking, coding workflows governed by structural formatting constraints).

Table 11: Compacted analytical reports generated by `Flat-Open` and `Urania` ($\varepsilon = 10.0$) on SynChat and representative extracted atomic statements (Round 1 of evaluation). We showcase representative statements illustrating open extracted distributions, entangled macro clusters, and keyword-level granular topics.

Generated Report (Compacted)	**Extracted Statement Examples**

Flat-Open:
`## Executive Summary`
`Dialogues are anchored in information seeking and creative writing, with STEM serving as the thematic backbone capturing over two-thirds of allocations ...`
`## Single-Attribute Distribution Breakdown`
`* **User Intent:** Information Seeking accounts for ≈ 30.3%, followed by Creative Writing (≈ 17.1%), Reasoning (≈ 11.0%), and Code Generation (≈ 10.6%) ...`
`## Multi-Attribute Relationships & Cross-Tabulations`
`* **Intent-Domain Dynamics:** Within Code Generation and Debugging, the STEM domain captures over 85% of instances ...`
`## Strategic Takeaways`
`1. **Ecosystem Specialization:** Rigorous technical problem-solving (STEM + Code Generation) coexists with extensive creative workflows ...`
	• Information seeking represents the single largest intent category, accounting for approximately 30.3% of all interactions.
	• STEM topics dominate the entire conversation corpus, accounting for approximately 68.8% of all topic assignments.
	• Formatting constraints govern approximately 43.1% of all interactions where user constraints are specified.
	• Within code generation and debugging, the STEM domain captures over 85% of instances.
	• Humanities topics capture roughly 20% to 22% of creative and editing workflows.
	... (67 total decomposed statements)

Urania:
`## Executive Summary`
`User engagement centers around three major thematic pillars: technical software engineering and database operations, advanced mathematical problem-solving, and creative writing combined with linguistic localization ...`
`## Macro Domain Breakdown`
`* **Macro Cluster ID 15 (≈ 25.7%):** Advanced Mathematics, Creative Writing, Translation, and Technical Formatting (bridges calculus, differential geometry, and number theory with creative writing and transliteration) ...`
`## Granular Topic & Keyword Analysis`
`* **Developer & Mathematical Workflows:** High term frequencies for markdown table (≈ 200 occurrences), csv format, and word count constraint alongside differential calculus and riemann zeta function ...`
`## Key Strategic Takeaways`
`1. **Ubiquity of Output Constraints:** Users rarely request unstructured text alone; output formatting constraints—from markdown and CSV tables to strict word counts—are foundational ...`
	• Version Control Systems, Database Operations, and Constrained Formatting (Macro Cluster ID 1) accounts for approximately 26.8% of the dataset.
	• Advanced Mathematics, Creative Writing, Translation, and Technical Formatting (Macro Cluster ID 15) represents roughly 25.65% of all interactions.
	• Users frequently request assistance with PostgreSQL database management, including database migration, database schema, and database schema design.
	• Prompts in developer and database workflows frequently impose strict output formats, highlighted by markdown table (approaching 200 occurrences), csv format, and word count constraint.
	• Users submit complex academic queries spanning analytic geometry, differential geometry, differential calculus, number theory, and the Riemann zeta function.
	... (40 total decomposed statements)

Flat-Close and Flat-Open capture 1-level macro distributions and bivariate cross-tabulations (e.g., technical STEM queries triggering code delivery), but remain restricted to top-level categories without resolving hierarchical sub-branches. Note that Flat-Open does not model the joint distribution. Therefore, its performance in multivariate QA is highly dependent on whether the attributes are not strongly related.

Finally, Urania represents the workload via 1D semantic clustering, yielding composite macro-clusters that jointly entangle topics, intents, and formatting rules (e.g., combining creative writing, translation, and advanced mathematics at $\approx 25.65\%$) alongside keyword-level frequency statistics for specific technical operations.

Table 12: Case study from SynChat_topic ($\varepsilon = 10$). The conversation moves through several unrelated domains. The second column includes the real categorizations and those by SHIP; "→" denotes a topic switch.

Raw Dialogue (Compressed)	**Algorithm & Categorization**
user: I am looking at an H-NMR spectrum for an unknown organic compound with the molecular formula C4H8O2. There is a triplet at 1.2 ppm, a quartet at 4.1 ppm, a singlet at 2.0 ppm … Can you help me piece this together? … **user:** On a completely different matter, we are heading into trial preparations for a breach of contract case, and opposing counsel just served a massive batch of unorganized emails. What is the best way to handle this electronic discovery dump? … **user:** This legal wrangling is tedious … Let's talk about something entirely different. What are the key turning points in the early political career of Alexander Hamilton?	**Ground Truth** • Topic path (level-1 categories only): `chemistry` → `litigation` → `history` **SHIP** • Topic path (level-1 categories only): `chemistry` → `law` → `history`
user: I have a monolithic function in my Python backend … How should I break this down to follow the single responsibility principle? … **user:** While sorting out those backend services, I also need to record our petty cash expenditures and reconcile the February bank statement. … **user:** Speaking of discrepancies, my Diels-Alder reaction keeps yielding the wrong stereoisomer. How can I control endo and exo selectivity? … **user:** That chemistry problem is getting too complicated. Instead, I need to draft a request to the judge to throw out the plaintiff's complaint. … **user:** This legal drafting is overwhelming … drop this entire line of questioning. How do modern historians analyze the biases in 19th-century colonial archives?	**Ground Truth** • Topic path (level-1 categories only): `programming` → `finance` → `chemistry` → `litigation` → `history` **SHIP** • Topic path (level-1 categories only): `programming`

Table 13: Average category counts and allocated records across attributes on WildChat.

ε	Level	Open-Set	Close-Set	Other & None
1.0	L0	13.5 (83.9%)	4.5 (2.5%)	1.8 (13.7%)
	L1	35.8 (80.2%)	43.0 (8.3%)	23.0 (11.5%)
	L2	29.8 (46.7%)	152.0 (37.6%)	74.0 (15.7%)
5.0	L0	16.3 (86.5%)	4.3 (1.0%)	1.8 (12.5%)
	L1	52.8 (89.3%)	37.3 (5.8%)	24.8 (5.0%)
	L2	55.0 (55.5%)	137.5 (32.1%)	93.0 (12.3%)
10.0	L0	20.8 (86.3%)	2.8 (0.6%)	2.3 (13.1%)
	L1	86.3 (86.1%)	30.3 (4.6%)	29.5 (9.4%)
	L2	70.8 (51.7%)	147.3 (33.0%)	119.8 (15.4%)

C.4 Contributions of Open-Set and Closed-Set Categories

Table 13 reports the average number of categories and their corresponding record proportions across attributes, with percentages shown in parentheses. At shallower levels (L0 and L1), open-set categories account for over 80% of records, while closed-set categories account for less than 10%. At the deepest level (L2), however, the contribution of closed-set categories increases substantially to 32.1–37.6%, while that of open-set categories drops to 46.7–55.5%. These results suggest that open-set partition selection effectively captures prevalent categories at coarse granularities, whereas closed-set supplementation becomes increasingly important for maintaining record coverage at finer granularities.

C.5 Challenging Query Examples

Table 12 contrasts two conversations from SynChat_topic, both annotated by SHIP in the same run at $\varepsilon = 10$. The pair is matched: both are cross-domain topic switches drawn from the same taxonomy and released under the same schema, so the only variable is the number of topics the user

Table 14: Record-level pairwise preference evaluation of SHIP against each baseline across four datasets under varying privacy budgets ε. Each cell is the average judge preference score on a 1-5 scale oriented toward SHIP: 5 strongly prefers SHIP, 3 is neutral, and 1 strongly prefers the baseline, so values above 3 favour SHIP (↑). Score denotes the workload-unaware judgement and Score$_w$ the workload-aware judgement.

ε	Comparison	WildChat		SynChat		CFPB		ChatDoctor	
		Score	Score$_w$	Score	Score$_w$	Score	Score$_w$	Score	Score$_w$
1.0	SHIP vs. `Urania`	4.219	4.330	4.634	4.631	4.265	4.207	4.481	4.577
	SHIP vs. `Flat-Close`	3.912	3.754	4.158	4.155	4.122	4.182	3.435	3.757
	SHIP vs. `Flat-Open`	3.793	3.768	4.136	4.159	3.893	4.083	3.645	3.851
5.0	SHIP vs. `Urania`	4.061	4.232	4.586	4.550	4.255	4.138	4.393	4.543
	SHIP vs. `Flat-Close`	4.004	3.944	4.418	4.413	4.315	4.378	3.499	3.839
	SHIP vs. `Flat-Open`	3.887	3.908	4.267	4.293	4.149	4.290	3.716	3.964
10.0	SHIP vs. `Urania`	4.115	4.234	4.596	4.561	4.247	4.149	4.354	4.489
	SHIP vs. `Flat-Close`	3.882	3.754	4.281	4.233	4.375	4.437	3.443	3.803
	SHIP vs. `Flat-Open`	3.898	3.887	4.218	4.230	4.195	4.355	3.740	3.962

visits. Ground truth is defined over level-1 categories, so we compare SHIP's release at level 1 as well, discarding the subcategory suffix it appends below that level.

In the first conversation, the user moves from NMR spectroscopy to electronic discovery to Alexander Hamilton's early political career, and SHIP recovers all three topics in the correct order. The one apparent mismatch, "law" where the ground truth reads "litigation", is a difference of granularity rather than of referent: "law" is exactly the parent domain of "litigation" in the generating taxonomy, so both names denote the same segment. The second conversation visits five domains under the same switching mechanics, and SHIP only releases the single topic "programming": four of the five leave no trace in the output.

C.6 Preference Evaluation Results

We additionally adopt the summary preference metric used in Urania's evaluation (Liu et al., 2025). Instead of scoring each output in isolation, this metric presents an LLM judge with the outputs of two algorithms for the same record and elicits a relative preference. We compare SHIP against each baseline in turn on a 1-5 scale oriented toward SHIP, where 5 strongly prefers SHIP, 3 is neutral, and 1 strongly prefers the baseline, so values above 3 favour SHIP. We elicit two judgements per record: the workload-aware judgement asks which output is more valuable for answering the workload query, and the workload-unaware judgement asks which output better describes the raw text.

Structured insight methods release tabular metadata whose correspondence with the raw records is altered by privatization. To compare all methods in a common format, we first use an LLM to verbalize each tabular record as a natural-language summary. We acknowledge that this conversion may affect the fairness of the evaluation. Urania already releases natural-language cluster summaries and is used as is. We randomise the presentation order on every call to control for position bias and evaluate every record of each dataset. Results are reported in Table 14.

Table 15: Deterministic QA results with different QA agent models on SynChat.

ε	Gemini		Sonnet	
	Avg Score	Acc (%)	Avg Score	Acc (%)
1.0	3.97	71.3	4.00	71.0
5.0	4.04	72.0	3.99	71.7
10.0	3.82	67.0	3.81	68.0

All results lie above the neutral value of 3, so SHIP is preferred over every baseline, on every dataset, at every privacy budget, and under both criteria. The baseline ordering is stable: Flat-Close and Flat-Open are the strongest competitors and differ little from one another, while `Urania` is the weakest everywhere. The gap to Urania is largely one of granularity rather than annotation quality, since it assigns each record the summary of its enclosing cluster while the structured methods emit record-specific descriptions. This also explains why the gap varies with the corpus: it is large on the diverse WildChat and ChatDoctor texts but nearly vanishes on the narrow, homogeneous complaints of CFPB, where a shared cluster summary is almost as informative as a record-level one. The two flat baselines are therefore the stricter points of comparison.

Table 16: Example QA agent execution trace involving scope resolution and category aggregation across taxonomy levels. Resource loading and unrelated code and outputs are omitted.

Query: Among user conversation constraints specifying output formatting, do list format requests (such as bulleted lists, numbered lists, checklists, and description lists) exceed 45% of all output formatting constraints?

Code

STDOUT

Step 1: Identify the reference population and inspect its categories.

```
formatting_rows = df[
  df['user_constraints (level 1)'] == 'formatting'
]
print(f"Total formatting constraint rows:
{len(formatting_rows)}")
print(
  formatting_rows['user_constraints (level 2)']
  .value_counts(dropna=False)
)
print(
  formatting_rows['user_constraints (level 3)']
  .value_counts(dropna=False)
)
```

```
Total formatting constraint rows: 4677

user_constraints (level 2)
bullet points: 241
numbered list formatting: 107
checklist formatting: 100
[other categories omitted]

user_constraints (level 3)
bulleted list: 349
numbered list structured output: 247
general bullet points: 178
checklist structured output: 100
markdown checklist: 91
numbering style constraint: 73
[other categories omitted]
```

Step 2: Combine matching categories across levels and calculate the proportion.

```
df_formatting = formatting_rows
list_formatting_count = len(df_formatting[
  df_formatting['user_constraints (level 2)'].isin([
    'bullet points',
    'numbered list formatting',
    'checklist formatting'
  ]) |
  df_formatting['user_constraints (level 3)']
  .str.contains(
    'bullet|list|checklist|numbered',
    case=False, na=False
  )
])
print(
  f"List formatting constraints count: "
  f"{list_formatting_count} / "
  f"{len(formatting_rows)} = "
  f"{list_formatting_count/len(formatting_rows)*100:.2f}%"
)
```

```
List formatting constraints count: 1144 / 4677 = 24.46%
```

Final answer: No. List format requests account for 1,144 out of 4,677 output formatting constraint rows in the released DP synthetic table (24.46%), which does not exceed 45%.

C.7 Robustness to the QA Agent Model

For experimental convenience, our main experiments use models from the Gemini family for both insight extraction and QA evaluation. To examine whether using the same model family in both stages substantially affects our evaluation, we replace the QA agent model with Claude Sonnet and repeat the deterministic QA evaluation on SynChat. We use the same released insight resources and retain all other evaluation settings, so that this comparison isolates the effect of the QA agent model. As shown in Table 15, replacing Gemini with Claude Sonnet changes the overall deterministic QA score by at most 0.05 and accuracy by at most 1.0% across the three privacy budgets. These results suggest that SHIP 's deterministic QA performance on SynChat is not substantially affected by this change in the QA agent model.

D Human Verification of Evaluation Agent

We present an example execution trace of our offline QA agent in Table 16. Using only SHIP's released synthetic table, the agent identifies the relevant reference population, inspects the available categories, and aggregates list-format requests across taxonomy levels without double counting. It then computes their proportion and compares it with the query's threshold. The displayed code and intermediate outputs allow human verification of the category mapping, denominator selection, numerical calculation, and final answer.

You are an expert data analysis assistant. The text you are classifying is part of a dataset described as: {dataset_description}. We have a set of annotation attributes to classify for the text below by discovering appropriate categories within a {max_depth}-level hierarchy.

(for each annotation attribute i = 1..n) Annotation {i}: "{annotation_name}"
Description: {annotation_description}
(if not root level) Parent Category Allocation Path for this Annotation: {parent_path}

Hierarchy Context:
- Total Taxonomy Depth: {max_depth} levels
- Current Classification Level: Level {current_level} of {max_depth}
(optional) - Hierarchy Examples (for granularity control only; you should propose category only based on the provided data):
  * {annotation_name}: {example_path}

GLOBAL RULES FOR OPEN CATEGORY DISCOVERY:
1. For each annotation, analyze the text and propose a concise, high-level, canonical category/subcategory name appropriate for Level {current_level} of {max_depth} that accurately captures the primary core topic of the text.
2. (root level) If the text does not contain information about the annotation, or if the annotation is not applicable or specified in the text, select "none". (e.g., If the attribute is "Format constraints" or "User constraints", you should output "none" instead of descriptive phrases like "no constraints" or "unconstrained" if the raw text does not specify any constraints).
2. (deeper levels) For subcategory classification under a parent category, if the text does not contain more details beyond the parent category, or if you think the parent category is enough for the record or not appropriate for further classification, select "none". Do NOT over-classify.
3. Category / Subcategory naming rules:
  - Every subcategory must logically entail all parent categories in its parent category allocation path.
  - DO NOT append parent category names, ancestor category names, or the annotation name. Just regard them as a known context. NEVER use any parent category in the path as a subcategory.
  - Be concise and simple without sacrificing precise meaning (1-2 words in lowercase English are preferred (e.g., "refund", "late fee"); but you can use more words if they are really necessary to better describe the data).
  - Strictly ban compound category/subcategory styles (such as "a and b" type). Focus on only one main object or concept that fits the raw text best.
  - Strip identifying details (proper nouns, personal names, numbers, specific dates, brand names); map to canonical conceptual category names.
4. Return the result ONLY as a valid JSON object mapping each annotation name to the proposed category name. For example:
  {
    "annotation_name_1": "billing",
    "annotation_name_2": "refund"
  }
5. Do not write explanations, outer markdown code block wrappers (like “‘json), or any extra text.
6. The output must be in lowercase English.

Text to classify: {text}

Your JSON output (invalid JSON will be rejected):

Figure 5: The prompts used for proposing categories for multiple attributes.

E Privacy Proof of SHIP

In this section, we present the complete mathematical proof for the privacy guarantee of SHIP (Algorithm 2). We consider the standard add-or-remove one DP in our work. We first provide a theorem about the relationship between DP and zCDP (Bun and Steinke, 2016).

Theorem 2 (Approximate zCDP to DP)**.** *If a randomized mechanism $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies δ'-approximate ρ-zCDP, then for any $\delta > \delta'$, $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies (ε, δ)-DP, where*

$$\varepsilon = \inf_{\alpha>1} \left\{ \alpha\rho + \log\left(1 - \frac{1}{\alpha}\right) - \frac{\log\left(\frac{\delta-\delta'}{1-\delta'}\right) + \log\alpha}{\alpha - 1} \right\}. \tag{4}$$

Throughout the proof, the workload $\mathcal{W}$, dataset description S_D, maximum depth d, and models are fixed independently of the private corpus. We condition on data-independent model randomness, coupled consistently for records shared by neighboring datasets; all bounds hold uniformly over this randomness. Given the preceding DP outputs,

You are an expert conversation analysis and data re-classification assistant. The text you are re-classifying is part of a dataset described as: {dataset_description}. We have a set of annotation attributes and their candidate categories (which include confirmed high-frequency categories and initialized complementary categories).

(for each annotation attribute i = 1..n) Annotation {i}: "{annotation_name}"
Description: {annotation_description}
(if not root level) Parent Category Allocation Path for this Annotation: {parent_path}
(root level) Candidate Categories:
(deeper levels) Candidate Subcategories under Parent:
- {candidate_1}
- {candidate_2}
- ...

Hierarchy Context:
- Total Taxonomy Depth: {max_depth} levels
- Current Classification Level: Level {current_level} of {max_depth}

RE-CLASSIFICATION RULES:
1. (root level) For each annotation, analyze the text and select the single category from Candidate Categories that best fits the primary core meaning/topic of the text.
2. (root level) If none of the candidate categories fit the text, select "other".
3. (root level) If the text does not contain information about the annotation, or if the annotation is not applicable or specified in the text, select "none" (e.g., output "none" instead of "no constraints" or "unconstrained").
1. (deeper levels) For each annotation, analyze the text and select the single category from Candidate Subcategories that best fits the text within the parent category context.
2. (deeper levels) If none of the candidate subcategories fit the text, select "other".
3. (deeper levels) If the text does not contain more details beyond the parent category, or if the parent category is sufficient and not appropriate for further classification, select "none".
4. Return the result ONLY as a valid JSON object mapping each annotation name to the chosen category/subcategory name (or "other" / "none"). For example:

```
{
  "annotation_name_1": "billing",
  "annotation_name_2": "other"
}
```

5. Do not write explanations, outer markdown wrappers (like “‘json), or any extra text.
6. The output must be in lowercase English.

Text to re-classify: {text}

Your JSON output (invalid JSON will be rejected):

Figure 6: The prompts used for re-classifying text based on complementary categories.

category proposal, reclassification, and allocation are performed record-wise. Record-level proposals and assignments remain internal and are not released.

Lemma 1 (Sensitivity of Partition Histograms)**.** *For any attribute A and depth level l, fix the preceding DP outputs. Index histogram bins by parent–category pairs (c_p, c) over a common category universe. Under add-or-remove-one-record adjacency, the joint count histogram $\mathbf{n}_{A,l} = (n_{c_p,c})$ across all active parent categories has global sensitivities*

$$\Delta_1 \leq 1, \qquad \Delta_2 \leq 1.$$

The same bounds hold for the histogram under any individual parent category c_p.

Proof. With the preceding DP outputs fixed, each record is routed to at most one active parent category c_p and contributes to at most one category count under that parent. Adding or removing one record leaves the routing and classification of all shared records unchanged. Consequently, the histogram difference is either zero or a vector with one nonzero entry equal to $+1$ or -1, giving

$$\|\mathbf{n}_{A,l}(\mathcal{D}) - \mathbf{n}_{A,l}(\mathcal{D}')\|_1 \leq 1,$$
$$\|\mathbf{n}_{A,l}(\mathcal{D}) - \mathbf{n}_{A,l}(\mathcal{D}')\|_2 \leq 1.$$

Records whose paths terminate at `other` or `none` contribute no further counts. The argument applies to both open category proposals and closed reclassification once their respective classification contexts are fixed. □

Lemma 2 (Privacy of Single-Level Hybrid Taxonomy Building)**.** *For any attribute $A \in \mathcal{A}$ and depth level $l \in \{1, \ldots, d\}$, condition on the preceding DP outputs. With $\rho_{open} = 0.9\rho_{step}$ and $\rho_{close} = 0.1\rho_{step}$, the thresholded open outputs*

You are analyzing a dataset described as: {dataset_description}. Your task is to generate a COMPLEMENTARY taxonomy for the annotation attribute named '{annotation_name}' (description: {description}).
(root level) Generate a FLAT (single-level, depth=1) set of top-level categories.
(deeper levels) Generate specific sub-categories to expand the parent category '{parent_path}'.

(if any passed categories at this node) ALREADY ESTABLISHED / PASSED CATEGORIES (root level) or SUBCATEGORIES UNDER PARENT '{parent_path}' (deeper levels):
The following categories have already been discovered and passed the filter:
- {passed_category_1}
- {passed_category_2}
- ...

RULES for complementary category generation:
- LOGICAL ENTAILMENT (deeper levels): Every sub-category must logically entail the parent category '{parent_path}'. NEVER include any parent or ancestor category in the path as a sub-category.
- MUTUAL EXCLUSIVITY WITH ESTABLISHED CATEGORIES: The new complementary categories must be strictly MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE with ALL the already established/passed categories listed above. Do NOT generate any categories that overlap, duplicate, or rephrase existing categories.
- MUTUAL EXCLUSIVITY AMONG NEW CATEGORIES: All generated complementary categories must be strictly MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE with each other.
- COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE: The complementary categories should cover the remaining meaningful aspects/topics of the annotation (root level) in this dataset / (deeper levels) under '{parent_path}' that are NOT covered by the established categories.
- (root level) Do NOT generate sub-categories or nested levels. Only produce top-level category names.
- Strictly ban generic placeholder categories (do NOT generate "none", "other", "unspecified", "not applicable", "miscellaneous", "n/a").
- Strictly ban compound categories (such as "a and b").
- Be concise (1-3 words per category name in lowercase English).

Figure 7: The prompts used for generating complementary categories.

and closed noisy histograms generated by Algorithm 1 across all active parent categories at this level jointly satisfy δ_{step}-approximate ρ_{step}-zCDP. Internal record assignments are excluded from this guarantee.

Proof. We analyze the open and closed stages jointly across all active parent categories.

In the open stage, histogram bins are indexed by parent–category pairs. For neighboring datasets $\mathcal{D}' = \mathcal{D} \cup \{x\}$, the added record can introduce at most one previously unobserved pair, whose count is one. Let E' be the event that no such pair is released on $\mathcal{D}'$, and let E be the certain event on $\mathcal{D}$. With $\sigma_{\text{open}} = 1/\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{open}}}$ and $\tau_{\text{open}} = 1+\sigma_{\text{open}}\Phi^{-1}(1-\delta_{\text{step}})$, an introduced pair survives with probability

$$\Pr[1 + Z \geq \tau_{\text{open}}] = \delta_{\text{step}}, \quad Z \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2_{\text{open}}).$$

Thus $\Pr[E'] \geq 1-\delta_{\text{step}}$. Conditioning on E' leaves the independent Gaussian noises on the common support unchanged. By Lemma 1, the conditioned output distributions P and Q are post-processing of Gaussian measurements with sensitivity at most one, so, for every $\alpha > 1$,

$$\max\{D_\alpha(P\|Q), D_\alpha(Q\|P)\} \leq \frac{\alpha}{2\sigma^2_{\text{open}}} = \alpha\rho_{\text{open}}.$$

Therefore, open discovery satisfies δ_{step}-approximate ρ_{open}-zCDP. This is the Gaussian partition-selection guarantee of Swanberg et al. (2023, Theorem 13), specialized to one category per record.

Complementary proposal and semantic deduplication depend only on the surviving DP categories and public information, and therefore incur no additional privacy cost. Conditioned on these outputs, each parent has a fixed candidate domain $\mathcal{C}_{\text{open}} \cup \mathcal{C}_{\text{comp}}$. Reclassification remains record-wise, so the joint closed histogram has L_2 sensitivity at most one by Lemma 1. Measuring every candidate count, including zero counts, with independent Gaussian noise of scale $\sigma_{\text{close}} = 1/\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{close}}}$ satisfies ρ_{close}-zCDP. Thresholding at τ_{close} and updating Ω_A are post-processing of the DP outputs.

By adaptive composition of approximate zCDP (Bun and Steinke, 2016, Lemma 8.2), the joint outputs satisfy δ_{step}-approximate $(\rho_{\text{open}} + \rho_{\text{close}})$-zCDP, where

$$\rho_{\text{open}} + \rho_{\text{close}} = \rho_{\text{step}}.$$

This bound covers all active parents together: adding or removing one record affects at most one parent–category pair, so neither privacy parameter scales with the number of parents. □

Proof of Theorem 1. For the analysis, let H denote the transcript containing all thresholded open-discovery outputs, closed Gaussian measurements, and their post-processing during taxonomy construction. Unfiltered record-level proposals and internal assignments are excluded from H.

By Lemma 2 and adaptive composition across all attributes and hierarchy levels, H satisfies δ_{tax}-approximate ρ_{tax}-zCDP, using the additive composition bounds

$$\sum_{A\in\mathcal{A}}\sum_{l=1}^{d}\rho_{\text{step}}=\rho_{\text{tax}},\qquad \sum_{A\in\mathcal{A}}\sum_{l=1}^{d}\delta_{\text{step}}=\delta_{\text{tax}}.$$

Early termination of record paths does not increase these bounds. The released taxonomy $\mathcal{T}=\{A:\Omega_A\}_{A\in\mathcal{A}}$ is post-processing of H.

For any fixed transcript H, each record's joint annotation $(y_i^{(A)})_{A\in\mathcal{A}}$ depends only on that record, H, and the fixed public inputs and model randomness. Adding or removing one textual record therefore adds or removes one row of the internal annotated table $\{(y_i^{(A)})_{A\in\mathcal{A}}\}_{i=1}^{N}$, leaving all shared rows unchanged. The privacy guarantee of AIM (McKenna et al., 2024) consequently applies under the same adjacency relation, giving ρ_{aim}-zCDP for its synthesis output conditional on H.

Adaptive composition with taxonomy construction yields δ_{tax}-approximate ρ_{total}-zCDP, where

$$\rho_{\text{total}}=\rho_{\text{tax}}+\rho_{\text{aim}}.$$

The released pair $(\mathcal{T},\widetilde{\mathcal{D}})$ is post-processing of the analyzed transcript and AIM output. For any target $\delta_{\text{tax}}<\delta<1$, define $\bar{\delta}=(\delta-\delta_{\text{tax}})/(1-\delta_{\text{tax}})$. Applying Theorem 2 gives (ε,δ)-DP with

$$\varepsilon=\inf_{\alpha>1}\left\{\alpha\rho_{\text{total}}+\log\left(1-\frac{1}{\alpha}\right)-\frac{\log\bar{\delta}+\log\alpha}{\alpha-1}\right\}.$$

This establishes the guarantee in Theorem 1. □

F Computational Cost Analysis

In this section, we provide an analysis of the computational cost of different insight extraction methods, focusing primarily on LLM API token consumption. Let N denote the number of records, L the average number of tokens per record, L_p the average prompt overhead for a record-level LLM call, and d the hierarchy depth. Since multiple attributes are processed jointly in our implementation, we do not introduce an additional multiplicative factor for the number of attributes. We use T_{tax} to denote the token cost of taxonomy-level LLM operations. These estimates characterize the dominant scaling behavior rather than exact API billing, since prompt and output lengths vary across datasets and intermediate taxonomies.

SHIP. At each hierarchy level, SHIP first performs open-set category discovery over the records assigned to all active nodes. Since these nodes partition the dataset, this requires one complete pass over the N records. Records whose discovered categories do not survive partition selection are subsequently re-classified over the supplemented candidate domain, requiring at most one additional pass. Therefore, under the fixed-depth implementation used in our experiments,

$$T_{SHIP}\geq dN(L+L_p)+T_{\text{tax}},$$
$$T_{SHIP}\leq 2dN(L+L_p)+T_{\text{tax}}.$$

The lower bound corresponds to the case where no re-classification is needed, while the upper bound assumes that all records require a second pass at every level. In practice, the cost lies between these two extremes.

Flat-Open / Flat-Close. Both flat structured baselines require only a single record-level classification pass. Although multiple attributes are extracted, they are processed jointly within the same LLM call in our implementation. Their dominant token cost is therefore

$$T_{\text{Flat-Close}}\approx N(L+L_p)+T^{*}_{\text{tax}}$$
$$T_{\text{Flat-Opne}}\approx N(L+L_p).$$

For Flat-Close, T^{*}_{tax} mainly corresponds to constructing the predefined taxonomy, whereas for Flat-Open it includes category consolidation after open-set discovery. Subsequent DP aggregation or tabular synthesis does not incur additional LLM token cost.

Urania. Urania performs a single LLM-based facet and keyword extraction pass over the corpus, followed by embedding computation and hierarchical clustering. Its record-level LLM token cost is therefore approximately

$$T_{\text{Urania}}\approx N(L+L_p)+T_{\text{sum}},$$

where T_{sum} denotes the cost of generating cluster summaries across the hierarchy. Unlike SHIP, Urania does not repeatedly process the raw records at

each hierarchy level: embeddings are computed once, the records are hierarchically clustered for d levels, and summaries are generated bottom-up from the resulting clusters. If K_ℓ denotes the number of clusters at level ℓ and $L_{\text{sum}}^{(\ell)}$ the average token cost of summarizing one cluster, then

$$T_{\text{sum}} \approx \sum_{\ell=1}^{d} K_\ell L_{\text{sum}}^{(\ell)}.$$

In addition to its LLM token cost, Urania incurs non-LLM computation for embedding inference and hierarchical clustering. We report this cost separately rather than converting it into API-token equivalents, since it depends on the embedding model, hardware, and clustering implementation.

Discussion. Overall, SHIP incurs higher LLM token cost than the flat structured baselines and more record-level API processing than Urania, with its cost scaling linearly with the hierarchy depth d. This additional computation reflects a trade-off between extraction cost and analytical utility: SHIP repeatedly processes the corpus to construct finer-grained hierarchical domains and recover information not captured by a single flat pass. As shown in our query-answering evaluation, this richer representation is associated with substantially stronger utility on both targeted and open-ended analytical queries. We therefore view the increased computational cost as an important limitation and a practical trade-off of SHIP, rather than a cost shared by all insight extraction approaches.

G Prompts

This paper involves many LLM API calls during execution, which requires proper prompts. Here, we provide four prompts that are used in SHIP:

- The prompt used to propose categories for each record is provided in Figure 5. These categories will go through partition selection after proposal.
- Figure 6 provides the prompt used to re-classify the text given generated complementary categories and proposed categories that pass the partition selection.
- The prompt used to generate complementary categories is provided in Figure 7.
- The prompt used to merge duplicate categories is provided in Figure 8. This step is conducted on those categories passing partition selection.

Moreover, we provide the prompts used in QA scoring in Figure 9.

H Generative AI Usage

We mainly use the Gemini family for coding and polishing writing, including main sections and appendix. The authors reviewed and verified the AI-assisted material and take full responsibility for the work.

You are an expert data taxonomy cleanup assistant. (root level) We have a set of newly discovered candidate categories for the annotation attribute "{annotation_name}" (Description: {description}):
(deeper levels) We have a set of newly discovered subcategories under the parent category "{parent_path}" for the annotation attribute "{annotation_name}" (Description: {description}):

(optional, variant A) Granularity Reference Example: {hierarchy_example}
(The reference example demonstrates the expected level of granularity/abstraction of canonical categories at each level. You must align the granularity of the merged canonical categories with this reference example.)
(optional, variant B) Reference Categories (granularity reference examples):
- {reference_category_1}
- {reference_category_2}
- ...
(The reference examples demonstrate the expected level of granularity/abstraction of canonical categories. You must align the granularity of the merged canonical categories with these reference examples.)

Newly Discovered Categories to Deduplicate and Merge:
- {discovered_category_1}
- {discovered_category_2}
- ...

Your task:
Analyze the newly discovered candidate categories, deduplicate them, and merge categories so that the resulting canonical categories are strictly MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE, well-consolidated, and match the target granularity demonstrated by the reference examples.
For any cluster of semantically identical categories, near-synonyms, phrasing variants, or duplicate terms describing the same concept, choose or create a single canonical, concise category name that captures their shared core concept, and map all input categories in that cluster to that canonical name.

RULES:
1. Every input category in the "Newly Discovered Categories" list MUST be mapped to a canonical category.
2. (root level) Canonical category names should be clear, concise (1-4 words in lowercase).
2. (deeper levels) Canonical category names should be clear, concise (1-4 words in lowercase). Each merged category must strictly remain a valid sub-category of the parent category "{parent_path}".
3. STRICT MUTUAL EXCLUSIVITY (DEDUPLICATE SYNONYMS & DUPLICATE PHRASINGS):
   - All canonical categories after merging MUST be strictly MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE with each other. No two canonical categories can have duplicate or overlapping meaning at the same level.
   - If multiple discovered categories are synonyms, near-synonyms, or slight phrasing variants of the same concept, you MUST merge them into a single canonical category.
4. GRANULARITY PRESERVATION (MERGING CANNOT CHANGE THE GRANULARITY):
   - The reference examples demonstrate the expected level of granularity and abstraction for canonical categories.
   - You MUST strictly preserve and align the granularity of the merged canonical categories with the reference examples.
   - CRITICAL REQUIREMENT: MERGING CANNOT CHANGE THE GRANULARITY. Merging is strictly for removing redundant duplicates, near-synonyms, phrasing variations, and identical concepts at the SAME semantic level of abstraction. You MUST NOT collapse distinct sub-disciplines, distinct subfields, or valid sibling categories (for example, merging "web development", "database systems", "software testing", or "algorithms" into an overly broad umbrella category like "software engineering" is STRICTLY PROHIBITED because it destroys the category granularity).
   - Valid, distinct sibling concepts must remain separate distinct canonical categories.
5. CONCISE CONSOLIDATION:
   - The resulting set of canonical categories should be clean and well-consolidated without redundant duplicates.
   - Consolidate minor wording variations or duplicate phrasings into clean canonical names, but never over-merge distinct sibling sub-topics.
6. "none" must map to "none" and not be merged with specific domain concepts.
7. All canonical category names must be in lowercase English.
8. Return the result ONLY as a valid JSON object where keys are the original input categories and values are the corresponding canonical/merged categories. For example:
```
{
  "discovered_cat_1": "discovered_cat_1",
  "discovered_cat_2": "merged_canonical_name",
  "discovered_cat_3": "merged_canonical_name"
}
```
9. Do not write explanations, code block markers (like ‘‘‘json), or any extra text.

Your JSON output (invalid JSON will be rejected):

Figure 8: The prompts used for de-duplicating proposed and survived categories.

(**Yes/No**) SCORING RULE:
- Score 5 (Match): The candidate answer gives the same binary verdict as Ground Truth (both are "Yes" or both are "No").
- Score 1 (Mismatch): The candidate answer contradicts Ground Truth (one says "Yes" while the other says "No"), hedges ambiguously, or fails to provide a clear verdict.

(**Comparison**) SCORING RUBRIC (1 to 5):
- [5] Perfect / Correct Winning Concept: Candidate correctly identifies the identical winning concept/category as Ground Truth. Natural language phrasing variations, synonyms, and expanded descriptive forms (e.g. "text transformation" vs "transforming and modifying existing text") are fully credited.
- [4] Correct Winner with Minor Imprecision: Candidate correctly identifies the winning concept, but its comparative margin or secondary supporting numbers have slight discrepancies.
- [3] Ambiguous / Inconclusive Comparison: Candidate describes both concepts without declaring a clear winner, falsely asserts they are equal/tied, or provides vague comparative evidence.
- [2] Inverted Comparative Direction: Candidate incorrectly declares the losing concept as the winner (e.g. claiming entity B exceeds entity A when Ground Truth establishes A exceeds B).
- [1] Completely Incorrect / Irrelevant: Candidate identifies an entity completely outside the comparison, hallucinates findings, or failed to answer.

(**Numerical**) SCORING RUBRIC (1 to 5):
- [5] Perfect / Highly Accurate: Candidate value has absolute error ≤ 0.05 (5 percentage points) OR relative error $\leq 10\%$ compared to Ground Truth. Correctly identified the target subset and denominator.
- [4] Minor Numerical Deviation: Candidate value has absolute error 0.05-0.10 OR relative error 10%-20%. Core calculation is sound with minor discrepancy due to sample noise or approximation.
- [3] Moderate Numerical Deviation: Candidate value has absolute error 0.10-0.25 OR relative error 20%-50%. Noticeable numerical discrepancy or partially imprecise subset filtering.
- [2] Severe Distortion: Candidate value has absolute error > 0.25 OR relative error $> 50\%$, or severely misidentified the denominator/reference population.
- [1] Completely Incorrect: Numerical value is completely wrong, off by orders of magnitude, unparseable, or missing.

(**Open-ended statements**) Rubric:
Focus primarily on semantic alignment; the numerical error bounds in the rubric below are provided for reference.
- [5] perfect alignment: The statement object is supported by a logically sound descriptive conclusion, and its statistical result (if given) maintains a strict error bound (EITHER a relative error of $< 10\%$ OR an absolute error of $< 5\%$, depending on the statement's context).
- [4] minor deviation: The descriptive conclusion preserves the primary narrative takeaway, while the paired statistical result (if given) contains a slight error (EITHER a relative error between 10% and 20% OR an absolute error between 5% and 10%, chosen based on context).
- [3] middle deviation: The descriptive conclusion blends true and false information that slightly alters the narrative, alongside a noticeable statistical result (if given) showing EITHER a relative error between 20% and 50% OR an absolute error between 10% and 25%, evaluated based on the statement's context.
- [2] severe distortion: The statement object is related to the source data but is fundamentally misrepresented by a severely distorted descriptive conclusion, or the statistical result (if given) introduces a massive error (EITHER a relative error of $>$ 50% OR an absolute error of $> 25\%$, evaluated based on the statement's context).
- [1] complete absence / insufficient information: The statement object is entirely absent from or unrelated to the source data, OR the available data lacks sufficient information to validate it (e.g., missing critical context such as asserting 'undergraduate students prefer X' when data provides no information about student types as the condition, or core claims cannot be found such as asserting 'Python web development' when data only shows 'general programming').

Figure 9: The prompts used for scoring the query answers or the statements.